פְּרִי צַדִּיק

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Sefer Shemos · Volume II

Mishpatim – Pekudei

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

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Pri Tzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Volume II · Mishpatim – Pekudei

This volume presents Pri Tzaddik on Parshas Mishpatim, Terumah, Tetzaveh, Ki Tisa, Vayakhel and Pekudei in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in numbered footnotes.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

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מִשְׁפָּטִים,
א׳ Mishpatim — Maamar Aleph

וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים אֲשֶׁר תָּשִׂים לִפְנֵיהֶם.[1] **Now these are the ordinances (mishpatim) which you shall set before them (Exodus 21:1).** בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ל): "מָשָׁל לְמַטְרוֹנָה שֶׁהָיְתָה מְהַלֶּכֶת, הַזַּיִן מִכָּאן וְהַזַּיִן מִכָּאן וְהִיא בָּאֶמְצַע; כָּךְ הַתּוֹרָה: דִּינִין מִלְּפָנֶיהָ וְדִינִין מֵאַחֲרֶיהָ וְהִיא בָּאֶמְצַע וְכוּ׳. **In Midrash Rabbah (Shemot Rabbah 30:3) it is taught: "A parable of a noblewoman who was walking with armed bodyguards (zayin) on this side and armed bodyguards on that side, while she walked in the center; so too is the Torah: judicial laws (dinin) precede it and judicial laws follow it, while it stands in the center, etc.:** מִלְּפָנֶיהָ – שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט'; מֵאַחֲרֶיהָ – שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים'".[2] **preceding it—as it is stated at Marah: 'There He made for them a statute and an ordinance' (Exodus 15:25); following it—as it is stated: 'Now these are the ordinances (mishpatim)'."'** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה שֶּׁאָמַר "מִלְּפָנֶיהָ" דִּכְתִיב בְּמָרָה "שָׁם שָׂם וְגוֹמֵר", **One must understand why the Midrash sought its proof-text for the laws preceding Sinai from the distant episode of Marah ("There He made for them a statute and an ordinance"),** וַהֲלֹא סָמוּךְ לַדִּבְּרוֹת כְּתִיב פָּרָשַׁת הַדַּיָּנִים, **when immediately adjacent to the Ten Commandments Scripture recorded the judicial appointments of Jethro,** מַה כָּתוּב לְמַעְלָה? 'וְשָׁפְטוּ אֶת הָעָם וְגוֹמֵר'"!"[3] **and indeed the Midrash itself opened by asking: "What is written just prior? 'And let them judge the people at all seasons'" (Exodus 18:22)!**

אַף הָעִנְיָן, דְּנִרְאֶה דִּדְבְרֵי הַמִּדְרָשׁ מְכֻוָּנִים לְמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּפָרָשָׁה זוֹ (צד עמוד א): **However, the explanation is that the words of the Midrash correspond directly to what is written in the holy Zohar on this portion (II 94a):** פָּתַח רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן: "'וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים וְגוֹמֵר' – תַּרְגּוּם: 'וְאִלֵּין דִּינַיָּא וְכוּ', אִלֵּין אִינּוּן סִדּוּרִין דְּגִלְגּוּלָא, דִּינִין דְּנִשְׁמָתִין וְכוּ׳",[4] **Rabbi Shimon opened: "'Now these are the ordinances, etc.'—the Aramaic translation is 'And these are the judgments, etc.'; these are the arrangements of reincarnation (gilgula), the spiritual judgments and rectifications of souls, etc.,"** וְגַם בְּסָבָא (דְּמִשְׁפָּטִים צה–קיב) עִנְיַן גִּלְגּוּלֵי דְּנִשְׁמָתִין.[5] **and likewise the entire discourse of the Elder (Saba d'Mishpatim, Zohar II 95a–112b) is dedicated to the transmigration of souls.** לָזֶה לֹא הֵבִיא הַמִּדְרָשׁ הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים דְּפָרָשַׁת יִתְרוֹ, שֶׁמְּדַבֵּר בְּמִשְׁפָּטִים שֶׁבֵּין אָדָם לַחֲבֵירוֹ בְּעִנְיְנֵי גַּשְׁמִיּוּת, **Therefore the Midrash did not cite the civil ordinances of Parashat Yitro, which deal merely with interpersonal disputes over monetary and physical matters,** וְכַוָּנַת הַמִּדְרָשׁ עַל מִשְׁפְּטֵי נִשְׁמוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּדִבְרֵי הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **for the true intention of the Midrash focuses upon the eternal judgments governing the souls of Israel, in accordance with the holy Zohar.**

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[1] **Exodus 21:1**: "These are the laws you shall set before them."

[2] **Shemot Rabbah 30:3**: "What is written above this passage? "They shall judge the people at all times." Here He says, "These are the judgments," with the commandments in the middle. It is like a queen walking with armed guards on this side and armed guards on that side, while she is in the middle. So the Torah has judgments before it and judgments after it, while it is in the middle. Likewise it says, "I walk in the path of righteousness." The Torah says: On what path do I walk? I walk in the way of those who practice righteousness. "Amid the paths of justice": the Torah is in the middle, with judgments before and after it. Before it: "There He established for him statute and judgment"; after it: "These are the judgments.""

Exodus 15:25: "He cried out to Hashem, and Hashem showed him a tree. He threw it into the water, and the water became sweet. There He established a statute and an ordinance for them, and there He tested them."

[3] **Exodus 18:22**: "They shall judge the people at all times. Every major matter they shall bring to you, but every minor matter they shall judge themselves. Lighten your burden, and let them bear it with you."

[4] **Zohar, Mishpatim 1:1-2:4**: "Rabbi Shimon began: 'These are the judgments you shall set before them.' The Targum renders: 'These are the judgments you shall arrange before them.' These are the arrangements of reincarnation, judgments concerning souls, each judged according to its punishment."

[5] **Zohar, Mishpatim 3**: "Here it says, 'If a man sells his daughter': this is the soul undergoing reincarnations because of evil deeds in the world. 'As a maidservant' means that Other Side, in an ill-fated return of the turning wheel. The soul has been oppressed, and must be brought out from there."

Context: The reference is to the Saba deMishpatim's extended treatment of souls and reincarnation, rather than only its opening narrative.

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ: "וְכֹה אָמַר הַכָּתוּב: 'בְּאֹרַח צְדָקָה אֲהַלֵּךְ' – הַתּוֹרָה אוֹמֶרֶת: בְּאֵיזֶה נָתִיב אֲנִי מְהַלֶּכֶת כּוּלֵי? 'בְּתוֹךְ נְתִיבוֹת מִשְׁפָּט' וְכוּלֵי",[6] **And this is what the Midrash continues: "And so Scripture states: 'I walk in the way of righteousness, in the midst of the paths of justice' (Proverbs 8:20)—the Torah declares: In which path do I walk? In the midst of the paths of justice, etc.,"** שֶׁלֹּא יִפְחֲדוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁבְּאִם יִכָּשֵׁל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם בְּדָבָר נֶגֶד דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֲבָדָה תִּקְוָתוֹ, כִּי מִי יוּכַל לְתַקֵּן אֲשֶׁר עִוָּות; **reassuring Israel that they need not despair, fearing that if one stumbles, Heaven forbid, against the Torah his hope is forever lost, asking: Who can rectify that which is crooked?** "לָזֹאת הִבְטִיחָה הַתּוֹרָה: "אֲנִי מְהַלֶּכֶת בְּתוֹךְ נְתִיבוֹת מִשְׁפָּט – **To this the Torah guarantees: "I walk in the midst of the paths of justice"—** "כִּי יָדוּעַ בְּמַאֲמַר פָּתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ דְּ"מִשְׁפָּט אִיהוּ רַחֲמֵי", **for it is known from Patach Eliyahu that "Mishpat (Justice / Tiferet) is Mercy (Rachamim),"** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ד עַמּוּד ב): "דִּין דְּלָא כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ אֱמֶת, הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹשֶׂה לִפְנִים מִשּׁוּרַת הַדִּין".[7] **and so it is stated in Avodah Zarah (4b): "In a judgment where absolute truth is not explicitly inscribed, the Holy One, blessed be He, acts beyond the letter of the law."** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְרַחֵם עַל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח, **And Hashem, blessed be He, has immense compassion upon the souls of Israel that none should be cast away,** וְכִדְאִיתָא בְּסָבָא שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְסַבֵּב לְנִשְׁמָתִין שֶׁיִּתּוּקַן הַכֹּל. **as explained in the Saba d'Mishpatim, that Hashem arranges cosmic transmigrations so that every single soul is ultimately repaired.** וּמִנִּשְׁמוֹת עֵר וְאוֹנָן וּמַחְלוֹן וְכִלְיוֹן הוּא בְּנִין מָשִׁיחַ, **And from the fallen souls of Er and Onan (via Perez) and Machlon and Chilyon (via Boaz and Ruth) was the royal lineage of the Messiah constructed!** וְאִיתָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יד עַמּוּד ב): "רוּת – פּוּרְעָנוּת דְּאִית לֵיהּ אַחֲרִית",[8] **And it is taught in Bava Batra (14b): "The Book of Ruth is an account of tribulation that possesses a glorious future,"** סוֹף הַפּוּרְעָנוּת נֶהֱפַךְ לְאַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה, שֶׁיָּצָא דָּוִד מִשָּׁם.[9] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: **which Rashi explains: the end of that tragedy was transformed into hope and ultimate destiny, because King David issued from there.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר הַכָּתוּב: "כִּי אָנֹכִי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת הַמַּחֲשָׁבֹת אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי חֹשֵׁב עֲלֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר, מַחְשָׁבוֹת שָׁלוֹם וְלֹא לְרָעָה, לָתֵת לָכֶם אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה",[10] **And this is what Scripture proclaims: "For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, says Hashem, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11),** וְאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית כט עַמּוּד ב): "אֵלּוּ דְּקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִּשְׁתָּן";[11] **upon which the Gemara comments (Ta'anit 29b): "This refers to date-palms and linen garments";** רָצוֹן לוֹמַר דִּבְגָלוּת בָּבֶל שָׁם הָיָה עִיקַּר הִתְיַסְּדוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה עַל יְדֵי אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה,[12] **meaning that in the Babylonian exile the foundation of the Oral Torah was established by the Men of the Great Assembly,** וְכֵן בַּדּוֹרוֹת שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ אִיתָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין מד עַמּוּד א): "דִּלְכוֹן אָמְרֵי דִּלְהוֹן הוּא",[13] **and in later generations the Talmud remarks concerning the Babylonians (Sukkah**

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[6] **Proverbs 8:20**: “I walk along the path of righteousness, within the ways of justice.”

[7] **Avodah Zarah 4b**: “Concerning Torah, where “truth” is written—as in “Acquire truth and do not sell it”—the Holy One, blessed be He, does not go beyond the strict line of judgment. Concerning judgment, where “truth” is not written, the Holy One, blessed be He, does go beyond the strict line of judgment.”

[8] **Bava Batra 14b**: “According to the view that Job lived in Moses’ time, why not place Job first? We do not begin with calamity. But Ruth also begins with calamity! Its calamity has a hopeful outcome, for Rabbi Yochanan said: Why was she named Ruth? Because David descended from her, and he abundantly offered the Holy One, blessed be He, songs and praises.”

[9] **Rashi on Bava Batra 14b:11:10**: ““It has a future”: The end of the calamity turns into a future and hope, because David emerged from there.”

[10] **Jeremiah 29:11**: “For I know the plans I am planning for you, declares Hashem—plans for peace, not for harm, to give you a future and hope.”

[11] **Taanit 29b**: ““To give you a future and hope”: Rav Yehuda son of Rav Shmuel bar Shilat said in Rav’s name: This refers to date palms and linen garments.”

[12] **Sukkah 44a**: “But R. Yohanan said: “I thought it was yours, but it is theirs!””

Commentary: **Rashi on Sukkah 44a:11:1**: ““But R. Yohanan said: I thought it was yours, but it is theirs”—Rav Kahana was one of Rav’s students and exceptionally sharp. He fled to the Land of Israel, to R. Yohanan, because of an incident in which he had killed a man, as related in the final chapter of Bava Kamma 117. R. Yohanan needed him to resolve several uncertainties. R. Yohanan used to say to the people of the Land of Israel: I thought the Torah was yours, since you had not been exiled from your land or suffered mental disruption. But I have seen that it belongs to the Babylonians: despite their exile, the wisdom of the craftsmen and smiths exiled with Jeconiah endured for them. It says, “All were mighty men, makers of war.” Seder Olam teaches: What feats of strength could people bound in iron chains perform? Rather, they were mighty in the warfare of Torah. Thus R. Yohanan held that Torah was not forgotten during the Babylonian exile.”

[13] **Sukkah 20a**: “Resh Lakish said: May I be an atonement for R. Hiyya and his sons! At first, when Torah was forgotten from Israel, Ezra ascended from Babylon and established it. It was forgotten again; Hillel the Babylonian ascended and established it. It was forgotten again; R. Hiyya and his sons ascended and established it.”

44a): "Yours is superior, for your scholars established it," וְשָׁם (כ עמוד א): "שֶׁבַּתְּחִלָּה כְּשֶׁנִּשְׁתַּכְּחָה תּוֹרָה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל עָלָה עֶזְרָא מִבָּבֶל וְיִסְּדָהּ וְכוּלֵי, עָלָה הִלֵּל הַבַּבְלִי וְיִסְּדָהּ וְכוּלֵי, עָלוּ רַבִּי חִיָּיא וּבָנָיו וְיִסְּדוּהָ",[14] **and in Sukkah 20a: "Initially when Torah was forgotten from Israel, Ezra ascended from Babylonia and established it; when it was forgotten again, Hillel the Babylonian ascended and established it; when it was forgotten again, Rabbi Chiya and his sons ascended and established it,"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בִּימֵי הָאֱמוֹרָאִים הַתַּלְמוּד בַּבְלִי, שֶׁהוּא עִיקָּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁלָּנוּ. **and subsequently in the era of the Amora'im the Babylonian Talmud was redacted, which is the mainstay of our Oral Torah.** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ד, יב): "צַדִּיקִים הֶעֱמִידָה לִי בְּחוּרְבָּנָהּ יוֹתֵר מִצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁהֶעֱמִידָה לִי בְּבִנְיָנָהּ", וְזֶהוּ הָאַחֲרִית טוֹב.[15] **And so the Midrash states (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:4:8): "She raised up for Me more righteous people in her destruction than the righteous people she raised up for Me when built," and this is the glorious ultimate hope.**

וּמַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ "דְּקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִשְׁתָּן", יֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּרָצָה לוֹמַר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (פְּסָחִים פז סוֹף עַמּוּד ב): "דָּגְלוּ לְבָבֶל כְּדֵי שֶׁיֹּאכְלוּ תְּמָרִים וְיַעַסְקוּ בַּתּוֹרָה",[16] **And regarding their reference to "date-palms and linen garments"—one may explain that date-palms corresponds to Pesachim (87b): "Israel was exiled to Babylonia so that they might eat sweet dates and immerse in Torah study,"** "דְּמֵינֵי מְתִיקָה (בַּיְרוּשַׁלְמִי פֶּרֶק ד דְּתַעֲנִית סוֹף הֲלָכָה ה): וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב "מַרְגֶּלֶת הַלָּשׁוֹן לַתּוֹרָה".[17] **as stated in the Jerusalem Talmud (Ta'anit 4:5): "sweet foods accustom the tongue to the sweetness of Torah."** – וּכְלֵי פִשְׁתָּן – הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (קִדּוּשִׁין עב עַמּוּד א): "'הַרְאֵנִי תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל' דּוֹמִים לְמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת",[18] **And linen garments corresponds to Kiddushin (72a): "'Show me the Torah scholars of Babylonia'—they resemble the ministering angels,"** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יְצְחָקִי: לְבוּשִׁים לְבָנִים וְכוּלֵי.[19] **which Rashi explains: they were robed in white linen garments, etc.** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים כ עַמּוּד ב): "מַאן מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת? רַבָּנַן וְכוּלֵי' – דְּמִצְיְינֵי כְּמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת", וְהַכָּוָנָה עַל רַבָּנַן דְּבָבֶל דִּקְרָאוּם כֵּן;[20] **And so in Nedarim (20b): "'Who are the ministering angels? The Rabbis'—for they are distinguished in white garments like ministering angels, referring to the Rabbis of Babylonia who were so designated;** וְאִיתָא (שַׁבָּת קמה עַמּוּד ב): "תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל מְצוּיָינִין לְפִי שֶׁאֵינָם בְּנֵי מְקוֹמָן וְכוּלֵי",[21] **and in Shabbat (145b): "Torah scholars in**

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[14] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:4:8**: "Rabbi Levi said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said: In her destruction she raised righteous people for Me; in her flourishing she raised wicked people for Me. In her destruction she raised righteous people: Daniel and his companions, Mordecai and his companions, Ezra and his companions. In her flourishing she raised wicked people: Ahaz and his companions, Manasseh and his companions, Amon and his associates. Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said in Rabbi Yochanan's name, concerning Rabbi Levi's teaching: "For the children of the desolate are more numerous than those of the married woman." Thus she raised more righteous people for Me in her destruction than in her flourishing."

[15] **Pesachim 87b-88a**: "Ulla said: So that they would eat dates and engage in Torah."
Context: The statement begins at the end of 87b and continues on 88a.

[16] **Jerusalem Talmud Taanit 4:5**: "Rabbi Hanina said: Forty years before Israel was exiled to Babylonia, date palms were planted in Babylonia, so that Israel would be drawn to sweetness, which trains the tongue for Torah."
Context: This is the Jerusalem Talmud's discussion, rather than Mishnah Ta'anit 4:5.

[17] **Kiddushin 72a**: "Rabbi said to Levi: Describe the Persians to me. He answered: They resemble the troops of David's house. Describe the Habbar priests to me. They resemble angels of destruction. Describe the Ishmaelites to me. They resemble the demons of the privy. Describe the Torah scholars of Babylonia to me. They resemble ministering angels."

[18] **Rashi on Kiddushin 72a**: ""They resemble ministering angels": They wear white and are wrapped like ministering angels, as it is written, "The man dressed in linen." Similarly, Shabbat 25b says of Rabbi Yehuda that he would wrap himself and sit in fringed linen garments, resembling an angel. Nedarim 20b likewise says: Who are the ministering angels? The Sages. Why are they called ministering angels? Because they distinguish themselves like ministering angels through fine clothing."

[19] **Nedarim 20b**: "Rabbi Yohanan said: This is Yohanan ben Dehavai's opinion. The Sages, however, said that the halakha does not follow Yohanan ben Dehavai: A man may do whatever he wishes with his wife. It is like meat from the butcher: If he wishes to eat it with salt, he may; roasted, he may; cooked, he may; thoroughly boiled, he may. The same applies to fish from the fisherman. Amemar said: Who are the ministering angels mentioned in his report? The Sages. If he meant actual ministering angels, why would Rabbi Yohanan say that the halakha does not follow Yohanan ben Dehavai? They understand the formation of the fetus better! Why, then, are the Sages called ministering angels? Because they distinguish themselves in dress like ministering angels."

[20] **Shabbat 145b**: "Why do the Torah scholars of Babylonia distinguish themselves through their clothing? Because they are away from their own place. As people say: In my own city, my name establishes me; away from my city, my clothing establishes me."

[21] **Bamidbar Rabbah 4:8**: "Adam was the firstborn of the world. When he offered his sacrifice—as it says, 'It shall please the Lord more than an ox or bull with horns and hooves'—he wore the garments of the High Priesthood, as it

Babylonia are uniquely distinguished in their dress because they are not in their home place, etc.," וּמַה שֶּׁאָמַר "שֶׁאֵינָם בְּנֵי מְקוֹמָן" – הַיְינוּ דְּמְקוֹם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְהָאָרֶץ קְדוּשָׁה וּמוֹסֶפֶת קְדוּשָׁה וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לְהִצְטַיֵּין עַל יְדֵי בִּגְדֵי קֹדֶשׁ. **which explicitly addresses those dwelling in Babylonia. And that which it states "because they are not in their home place"—means that the natural home of Israel is the Land of Israel, which is inherently holy and confers holiness so that one does not need special vestments to achieve distinction;** וּבָבֶל אֵינוֹ מָקוֹמָן, וּמְשׁוּם דְּלֵיכָּא קְדוּשַׁת מָקוֹם צָרִיךְ קְדוּשַׁת בְּגָדִים. **whereas Babylonia is exile, and lacking the intrinsic sanctity of place, they required the sanctification of garments.** וּבָגָד הַמְיוּחָד לְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים הוּא כְּמוֹ בִּגְדֵי כְּהֻנָּה, בִּגְדֵי קֹדֶשׁ "לְכָבוֹד וּלְתִפְאֶרֶת", שֶׁעַל יְדֵי לְבִישַׁת הַבְּגָדִים נַעֲשֶׂה רָאוּי לְכָבוֹד וּלְתִפְאֶרֶת. **And the special white linen of Torah scholars is like the priestly vestments—holy garments "for honor and for glory"—through which the wearer becomes invested with honor and majesty.** וְכֵן בִּגְדֵי שַׁבָּת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (בַּמִּדְבָּר פָּרָשָׁה ד) עַל בִּגְדֵי אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן: לָבַשׁ בִּגְדֵי כְהֻנָּה גְּדוֹלָה וְכוּלִי, בִּגְדֵי שַׁבָּת הָיוּ וְכוּלִי, וְעַל כֵּן הֵם שֶׁל פִּשְׁתָּן.[22] **And so too are Shabbat clothes, as written in Bamidbar Rabbah (4:8) regarding Adam's garments: he wore High Priestly garments, which were Shabbat garments, made of pure white linen.** וְכֵן מִיכָאֵל הַמַּלְאָךְ הוּא כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף מָנָחוֹת קי עַמּוּד א) שֶׁהוּא מַקְרִיב בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁל מַעְלָה,[23] **And Michael the archangel is the supernal High Priest who serves in the Heavenly Temple (Menachot 110a), clothed in white linen (Daniel 10:5),** וּבְסֵפֶר חֶסֶד לְאַבְרָהָם (עֵין יַעֲקֹב נָהָר נב) בֵּיאֵר סוֹד לְבִישַׁת בִּגְדֵי פִּשְׁתָּן.[24] **and in Sefer Chesed LeAvraham (Ein Yaakov, Nahar 52) he explains the mystical secret of wearing linen garments.**

"וְלֹא יִתְיָאֵשׁ שׁוּם אָדָם מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, כִּי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חוֹשֵׁב מַחֲשָׁבוֹת לְבִלְתִּי יַדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח, וְהַיְינוּ "מִשְׁפָּטִים מֵאַחֲרֵיהָ": **Therefore let no Jew ever despair, for the Holy One devises means that none be banished from Him—and this is the meaning of "ordinances following the Torah":** שֶׁלֹּא יֹאבַד שׁוּם נֶפֶשׁ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, וְיִתּוּקַן עַל יְדֵי גָּלוּת אוֹ גִּלְגּוּל וְזֶהוּ פָּרָשַׁת מִשְׁפָּטִים.[25] **that no soul of Israel shall ever be lost, being rectified**

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says, 'The Lord God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife, and clothed them.' They were garments of distinction, and the firstborn would serve in them."

Context: The Midrash's wording is bigdei shevach, "garments of glory"; Rav Tzadok's wording here identifies them as Sabbath garments.

[22] **Daniel 10:5**: "I raised my eyes and saw a man dressed in linen, with a belt of pure gold from Uphaz around his waist."

Context: Daniel describes an unnamed figure clothed in linen. Michael's heavenly service is supplied by the other sources cited here.

Menachot 110a: ""This is forever incumbent upon Israel." Rav Giddel said in Rav's name: This refers to an altar already built, at which Michael, the great prince, stands and offers a sacrifice. Rabbi Yochanan said: It refers to Torah scholars engaged in studying the laws of the Temple service; Scripture credits them as though the Temple had been built in their days."

Context: The Gemara describes Michael offering a sacrifice on the heavenly altar; "High Priest" is Rav Tzadok's description of that role.

[23] **Chesed LeAvraham, Even Shetiya, Maayan 4 52**: "I found the following in a manuscript: Know that wearing linen garments contains a great secret, benefiting the living and the dead, young and old. For every deceased person clothed in white linen shrouds, even one who died outside the Land of Israel, every accuser is transformed into an advocate. Whoever wishes to investigate, examine, test, and experience the wondrous property of wearing linen garments without any other fabric—even an infant whose father is known to have lost many children through wicked Lilith, an evil spirit, or any spiritual force of the left side—is protected from all these harms by the special property of these garments."

Context: Ein Yaakov is the fourth Maayan; this is the cited discussion of linen garments.

[24] Parallel: **Da'at Tevunot 52:2**: "Nevertheless, He did not wish to leave His world perpetually agitated by the partnership of good and evil. Rather, His great goodness established a mode of governance and a profound design, directing all things, through good and evil themselves, toward the complete repair possible for them. It belongs to His perfection that His works should ultimately be perfected and not remain deficient. This, however, is not the action of His simple perfection as it is in itself, which cannot be apprehended; His simplicity has no place in our discussion at all. Rather, this is what I said: it belongs to His perfection that, even when He wishes to act only according to the measure of created beings, He should act with them in perfection. This is the source of providential governance: the profound design I mentioned, which turns and draws everything toward complete repair."

Connection: Ramchal sets this hope within providential governance: good and evil do not remain a permanent balance, because God directs His works toward completed repair; this does not turn evil acts into a present duty.

[25] **Bava Kamma 82a**: "Did Ezra institute public Torah reading on Mondays and Thursdays? It had already been instituted earlier. A baraita teaches: "They traveled three days in the wilderness and found no water." Those who expound the verse's allusions said: Water means Torah, as it says, "Let everyone who thirsts come to the water."

through exile, reincarnation, and the like, which is the ultimate purpose of all exiles and the essence of Parashat Mishpatim. גַּם כֵּן מְרוּמָז בָּמָרָה: "וְ"מִשְׁפָּטִים מִלְפָנֶיהָ" **And "ordinances preceding the Torah" is likewise hinted at Marah:** כִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם הָיוּ מְשׁוּקָעִים בְּקִלִּיפַּת מִצְרַיִם, וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שָׁלַח עֶשֶׂר מַכּוֹת וְהוֹצִיאָם מִשָּׁם; **for Israel in Egypt had been submerged in the husks of Egypt, and Hashem sent the ten plagues and extracted them from there;** וְגַם עַל הַיָּם הָיָה הַקְּטָרוּג: "מַה נִּשְׁתַּנּוּ אֵלּוּ מֵאֵלּוּ", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (תְּרוּמָה קע עמוד ב), כִּי גַּם בַּיָּם לֹא הָיוּ שְׁלֵמִים, **and even at the Sea the prosecuting angels challenged: "How are these different from those?", for even at the Sea they were not yet fully purified,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח) עַל "וְהַמַּיִם לָהֶם חוֹמָה" – אַל תִּקְרֵי "חוֹמָה" אֶלָּא "חֲמָה". פָּסוּק **as expounded in the Mekhilta on the verse "and the waters were a wall (chomah) unto them"—read not chomah (wall) but chemah (wrath);** רַק מִצַּד הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא שֶׁלֹּא עַל פִּי שִׂכְלָ אֱנוֹשִׁי "רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם וּבִזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם), **only that through the suprarational revelation of Atika Kadisha, "a maidservant saw at the Sea what Ezekiel did not see,"** כִּי רָאוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדוּשָּׁתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ מֵאוֹר עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא שֶׁהֵאִיר לָהֶם. **because all Israel beheld His blessed holiness from the light of Atika that illuminated for them.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁהִסִּיעָם מֹשֶׁה מִן הַיָּם וְנֶעֱלַם מֵהֶם הָאוֹר הַגָּדוֹל, **And afterward, when Moses led them journeying away from the Sea and that immense light became hidden,** אָז הוּמַר לָהֶם בְּזָכְרָם מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם הָרִאשׁוֹנִים בִּהְיוֹתָם מְשׁוּקָעִים בְּמִצְרַיִם, **their spirits became embittered as they remembered their previous defilements in Egypt,** וְהָיוּ רְאוּיִים לְכָל מַכּוֹת כְּהַמִּצְרִיִּים, וְאֵיךְ יוּכְלוּ לְתַקֵּן הַמַּעֲוֹת? **recognizing that by strict justice they had deserved all the plagues like the Egyptians, and crying: How can we ever rectify our past?** וְהֵיצַר לָהֶם שֶׁחָשְׁבוּ כִּי אָפֵס תִּקְוָה וְיִלְקוּ עוֹד בְּמַחֲלַת מִצְרַיִם. **And they were plunged into anguish, fearing that hope was gone and that they would yet be stricken with the diseases of Egypt.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לִשְׁתּוֹת מַיִם מִמָּרָה כִּי מָרִים הֵם", וְאֵין מַיִם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא קַמָּא פב עמוד א) אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה,[26] **And this is what is stated: "and they could not drink of the waters of Marah, for they were bitter" (Exodus 15:23)—and "water" is nothing other than Torah (Bava Kamma 82a)—** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמַּהַדְּבָרֵי תּוֹרָה עַצְמָם הָיָה מַר לָהֶם, **meaning that the very words of Torah tasted bitter to them,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פז עמוד א): "'וַיַּגֶּד מֹשֶׁה' – דְּבָרִים שֶׁקָּשִׁין לְאָדָם כְּגִידִין",[27] **in the manner of what is taught (Shabbat 87a): "'And Moses reported (va-yaged)'—words that are as hard for a person to absorb as sinews (giddin),"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּעָרוּךְ דְּתַרְגּוּם לַעֲנָה מָרָר כְּגִידִין;[28] **and as the Arukh notes, the Targum translates wormwood as "bitter as sinews";** כִּי הֲבִינוּ מֵהַדְּבָרֵי תּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר קִלְקְלוּ בְּמִצְרַיִם.[29] **because from the**

After three days without Torah they grew weary. The prophets among them therefore instituted reading on Shabbat, pausing on Sunday, reading on Monday, pausing on Tuesday and Wednesday, reading on Thursday, and pausing on Friday, so that they would not pass three days without Torah. Initially they instituted either one person reading three verses, or three people reading three verses, corresponding to priests, Levites, and Israelites. Ezra then instituted three readers and ten verses, corresponding to the ten men who remain available for the community."

Exodus 15:23: "They came to Marah, but could not drink the water of Marah because it was bitter; therefore its name was called Marah."

[26] **Shabbat 87a**: "A baraita teaches: "Moses brought back the people's words to the Lord," and it also says, "Moses told the people's words to the Lord." What did the Holy One, blessed be He, say to Moses? What did Moses say to Israel? What did Israel say to Moses? And what did Moses report before the Almighty? This concerns the command to set a boundary—Rabbi Yose bar Yehuda's view. Rabbi says: At first he explained its punishment, as it says "Moses brought back"—words that unsettle a person's mind. Finally he explained its reward, as it says "Moses told"—words that draw a person's heart like aggada. Some say: At first he explained its reward—words that restore a person's mind. Finally he explained its punishment, as it says "Moses told"—words as hard for a person as sinews."

[27] **Sefer HeArukh, s.v. Gad (Letter Gimel 57)**: "Gad: wormwood. In Shabbat 86, 'He told' is interpreted as words hard as gidin. The explanation is that the dalet is doubled, and it means wormwood. 'I will feed this people wormwood' is translated with bitterness like gidin; similarly, 'Those who turn justice into wormwood,' and 'Her end is bitter as wormwood'—bitter like gidei."

[28] **Exodus 15:26**: "He said, "If you listen carefully to the voice of Hashem your God, do what is upright in His eyes, attend to His commandments, and observe all His statutes, I will place upon you none of the illnesses I placed upon Egypt, for I am Hashem, your healer.""

[29] Parallel: **R. Yaakov Leiner, Beit Yaakov on Torah, Mishpatim 32, 153b**: "'If you see your enemy's donkey lying beneath its burden, would you refrain from helping him? You shall surely help with him.' Bava Metzia 32a says that the Torah commands unloading without payment, whereas loading may be done for payment. There are two harmful opinions through which a person can go astray. One person says, God forbid, that God has abandoned the earth and there is neither judgment nor Judge. Another says that the Holy One never makes any allowance at all. If either suffers a failure, God forbid, he may go astray. The commandments of loading and unloading address these two opinions. Against the claim that God has abandoned the earth stands loading: one must load upon himself the burden

holy standards of the Torah they realized how severely they had transgressed in Egypt. וְלָכֵן כָּתוּב: "שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט" – הֵיינוּ מִשְׁפַּט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעִנְיְנֵי נִשְׁמוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁחוֹשֵׁב עֲלֵיהֶם מַחֲשָׁבוֹת לְבִלְתִּי יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח. **Therefore Scripture states: "There He made for them a statute and an ordinance (mishpat)"—referring to Hashem's compassionate ordinance governing the souls of Israel, devising means that none be cast away.** וְכָתוּב אַחַר כָּךְ: "כָּל הַמַּחֲלָה אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְמִצְרַיִם לֹא אָשִׂים עָלֶיךָ כִּי אֲנִי ה' רֹפְאֶךָ",[30] **And immediately following this it is written: "all the diseases which I put upon the Egyptians I will not put upon you, for I am Hashem your Healer" (Exodus 15:26),** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף אִם אָשִׂים עָלֶיךָ, לֹא אָשִׂים כְּדַרְכּוֹ אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּמִצְרַיִם: **meaning: even if I do bring afflictions upon you, I will never bring them in the destructive manner in which I placed them upon Egypt:** דְּשָׁם בָּאוּ הַמַּכּוֹת לְהַאֲבִידָם, מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן עֲלֵיכֶם לֹא אָשִׂים רַק דַּרְכּוֹ רְפוּאָה,[31] **for upon Egypt the plagues fell to annihilate them, whereas upon you I will bring them solely as healing medicine,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּחַתְּכִין מַכָּה, דְּאַף שֶׁיִּכְאַב לִשְׁעָתוֹ אֲבָל הוּא לְטוֹבָה לְהַחֲזִירוֹ לִבְרִיאוּתוֹ, **like a surgeon who cuts into a wound, which although painful at the moment is intended for the patient's recovery,** וְכֵן יִהְיוּ הַיִּסּוּרִין בִּכְדֵי לְרַפְאוֹת אֶתְכֶם; **and so shall all tribulations of Israel be: solely to cleanse and heal you;** וְיִהְיֶה "פּוּרְעָנוּת דְּאִית לֵיהּ אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה", כִּי "בְּתוֹךְ נְתִיבוֹת מִשְׁפָּט" הַתּוֹרָה מְהַלֶּכֶת, כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מָלֵא רַחֲמִים עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְעַל נַפְשׁוֹתָם:[32] **and it will be a "tribulation that possesses a glorious future and hope," for the Torah walks "in the midst of the paths of justice (Rachamim)," since Hashem is filled with mercy toward Israel and their souls:**

מִשְׁפָּטִים, ב׳ Mishpatim — Maamar Bais

"וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים וְגוֹמֵר". בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "אַף כָּאן 'וְאֵלֶּה' – מוֹסִיף עַל הָרִאשׁוֹנִים, מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב לְמַעְלָה: 'שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט". **Now these are the ordinances, etc. In Midrash Rabbah (30:2): "Here too the connective Vav in 'And these (Ve-eleh)' adds to the former ones—namely what is written above: 'There He made for them a statute and an ordinance (mishpat).'"** דָּבָר אַחֵר: 'וְאֵלֶּה וְגוֹמֵר' – מָשָׁל לְמַטְרוֹנָה וְכוּלֵי הַזַּיִן מִכָּאן וְהַזַּיִן מִכָּאן וְכוּלֵי, כָּךְ הַתּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי: מִלְּפָנֶיהָ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט', וְדִינִין מֵאַחֲרֶיהָ: 'וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים'". **Another exposition: 'Now these, etc.'—a parable of a noblewoman walking with armed guards (zayin) on this side and on that side; so too the Torah: preceding it, 'There He made for them a statute and an ordinance,' and judgments following it, 'Now these are the ordinances.'"** וְהִנֵּה מֵהַמָּשָׁל לְ"זַיִן מִכָּאן וּמִכָּאן", שֶׁפֵּירוּשׁוֹ אַנְשֵׁי חַיִל וּכְלֵי זַיִן כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הַמַּתְּנוֹת כְּהֻנָּה, **Now from the parable of "zayin on this side and zayin on that side"—which means armed soldiers bearing weapons (klei zayin) as the Matnot Kehunah explains—** נִרְאֶה שֶׁהַמִּדְרָשׁ מְפָרֵשׁ הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים הֵיינוּ הָעוֹנָשִׁין, **it appears that the Midrash interprets mishpatim here as the retributive punishments and**

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of Heaven's kingship, with wholehearted service and fear, because he has thrown off the yoke entirely. Hence loading is done for payment. Against the claim that, after a failure, there can be no repair because God makes no allowance stands unloading. A little of that fear must be unloaded from him, for God is good and forgiving. Bereishit Rabbah 32 says that only some of the praise of Him who spoke and the world came into being is said in His presence: 'Say to God, how awesome are Your deeds.' Away from His presence one says, 'Give thanks to God, for He is good, for His kindness is forever.' 'In His presence' means that beforehand a person must conduct himself with fear and service, without entering doubtful situations in reliance upon His everlasting kindness. But concerning the past, if a failure has occurred, God forbid, he must not despair of repair. This is 'away from His presence': 'Give thanks to God, for He is good, for His kindness is forever.' God devises ways so that no outcast shall be cast away from Him."

Connection: Beit Yaakov distinguishes the fear needed before acting from the hope needed after failure. The same legal system can load the yoke of Heaven onto the careless and unload despair from the penitent.

[30] **Amos 9:9**: "For I am about to give the command and shake the house of Israel among all the nations, as one shakes a sieve, without a single pebble falling to the ground."

[31] **Zohar, Mishpatim 22:536-23:542**: "'In all that I have said to you, you shall be guarded.' Why tishameru, 'be guarded,' rather than tishmeru, 'guard'? Precisely 'be guarded.' 'All that I have said' means the assurance I have given you concerning My service: you shall be guarded so that no evil reaches you, through My protection alone. 'Do not mention the name of other gods' is as explained. Another interpretation: do not bring about your falling among the nations in a foreign land, so that 'There you shall serve other gods' is fulfilled in you."

Exodus 23:13: "Be watchful concerning everything I have told you. Do not mention the name of other gods; let it not be heard from your mouth."

[32] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Tavo 10-11**: "Go and see: a king who loves his son, even when he curses and strikes him, loves him in his innermost being. When he displays fierce anger, compassion for him is present. So too with the Holy One, blessed be He: although He curses, His words are spoken in love. Outwardly they appear as curses, yet they are many benefits, because these curses were given in love. This was not so with the earlier ones, which were all given with severe judgment. In these there are judgment and love together, like a father who loves his son and holds a whipping strap in his hand: he makes a great roar and loud threats, but the lashes are light, administered with compassion."

strict disciplines, וְעַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ רֵישׁ פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ: "דִּינִין דְּנִשְׁמָתִין דְּאִתְדָּנוּ כָּל חַד וְחַד לָקֳבֵל עוֹנָשִׁין **in line with what is written in the holy Zohar at the beginning of this portion: "the judgments of souls, wherein each soul is judged according to its needed purifications,"** וְהַיְינוּ עִנְיַן כָּל הָעוֹנָשִׁין בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְעוֹלָם הַבָּא כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יֹאבַד מִמֶּנּוּ נֶדֶף; **which refers to all disciplines in this world and the World to Come designed to ensure that no soul be eternally cast away;** וְאַף אִם הִרְבָּה לִפְשׁוֹעַ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם, יֵשׁ עֵצוֹת אֲצֻלּוֹת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ לְטַהֲרוֹ עַל יְדֵי גֵּיהִנֹּם אוֹ גִּלְגּוּלִים, וְכֵן תַּכְלִית כָּל הַגָּלִיּוֹת כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יִפּוֹל צְרוֹר אֶרְצָה (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה).[33] **and even if one sinned grievously, Heaven forbid, Hashem has profound counsels to purify him through Gehinnom or reincarnations, this being the purpose of all exiles so that "not the least kernel falls upon the earth" (Amos 9:9; as explained above).** אַךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמַר הַזַּיִן לְפָנָיו "חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט", לִכְאוֹרָה לֹא נִרְאָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לָהֶם בְּמָרָה עוֹנָשִׁין! **Yet regarding the armed guards preceding the Torah, "a statute and an ordinance"—at first glance it does not seem that retributive punishments were spoken to them at Marah!**

אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, דְּאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ (קכג עמוד ב): **However, the matter is illuminated by what is stated in the holy Zohar on this portion (II 123b): "'** וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ' – מַאי 'תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ'? 'תִּשְׁמְרוּ' מִיבָּעֵי לֵיהּ! אֶלָּא "כּוּלֵי, כַּאֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי לָכֶם, כְּלוֹמַר דְּאַגְּזִימִית לְכוֹן עַל מֵימַר פּוּלְחָנִי, תִּשָּׁמְרוּ דְּלָא יִמְטֵי עֲלַיְיכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ וְכוּלֵי". "'[34] **And in all that I have said unto you take heed (tishameru)' (Exodus 23:13)—why does it say tishameru (be guarded/saved) rather than the active tishmeru (you shall observe)? Rather: 'according to all that I have said to you'—meaning, concerning the severe penalties that I threatened you regarding My worship, you shall be protected (tishameru) so that no evil shall reach you, etc."** וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מוּבָן:[35] **And seemingly this is difficult to understand:** דְּיִתָּכֵן בְּפָרָשַׁת כִּי תָבֹא שֶׁבָּאוּ הַתּוֹכָחוֹת – **for such an explanation is understandable in Parashat Ki Tavo, where the rebukes appear—** וְאִיתָא בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ שָׁם דְּאִלֵּין קִלָלוֹת בִּרְחִימוּ הֲווֹ וְכוּלֵי, כְּאַבָּא דְּרָחֵים עַל בְּרֵיהּ וּרְצוּעָה דְּמַלְקֵיוּתָא נָקִיט בִּידֵיהּ, עָבֵיד נְהִימוּ סַגִּי וְקָלִין רַבְרְבִין וּמַלְקֵיוּתָא קָלִילִין בְּרַחֲמֵי וְכוּלֵי – **as the Zohar Chadash notes there, that those curses were spoken in love, like a loving father holding a strap who roars loudly and makes great noise but strikes only gently with compassion—** וְשַׁיָּיךְ לְשׁוֹן דְּאַגְּזִימִית לְכוֹן", אֲבָל כָּאן לֹא נֶאֱמַר עֲדַיִן פָּרָשַׁת הַתּוֹכָחוֹת"! **so that the phrase "that I threatened you with penalties" is well understood; but here in Parashat Mishpatim the rebukes had not yet been spoken!** וְיִתָּכֵן דְּקָאֵי עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַתַּגֵּד לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל", וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "עוֹנָשִׁין וְדִקְדּוּקִין פֵּירֵשׁ לַזְּקֵנִים, דְּבָרִים הַקָּשִׁין

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[33] **Rashi on Exodus 19:3**: "'Moses ascended': on the second day. All his ascents were early in the morning, as it says, 'Moses rose early in the morning.' 'Thus shall you say': in this language and this order. 'To the house of Jacob': these are the women; speak to them gently, as taught in Mekhilta. 'And tell the children of Israel': explain the punishments and precise requirements to the males—words as hard as sinews, as taught in Shabbat 87."

Exodus 19:3: "Moses ascended to God, and Hashem called to him from the mountain, saying, "Thus shall you say to the house of Jacob and declare to the children of Israel.""

[34] **Shabbat 87a**: "A baraita teaches: "Moses brought back the people's words to the Lord," and it also says, "Moses told the people's words to the Lord." What did the Holy One, blessed be He, say to Moses? What did Moses say to Israel? What did Israel say to Moses? And what did Moses report before the Almighty? This concerns the command to set a boundary—Rabbi Yose bar Yehuda's view. Rabbi says: At first he explained its punishment, as it says "Moses brought back"—words that unsettle a person's mind. Finally he explained its reward, as it says "Moses told"—words that draw a person's heart like aggada. Some say: At first he explained its reward—words that restore a person's mind. Finally he explained its punishment, as it says "Moses told"—words as hard for a person as sinews."

[35] **Berakhot 54a**: "A person must bless God for misfortune as he blesses Him for good, as it says, "You shall love Hashem your God with all your heart." "With all your heart" means with both your inclinations, the good inclination and the evil inclination. "With all your soul" means even if He takes your soul. "With all your might" means with all your property. Another interpretation: Whatever measure He measures out to you, acknowledge Him for it."

Peri Tzadik, Vayechi 3: "Earlier authorities wrote that kol, 'all,' applies to at least three. In truth, we find several verses and statements of the Mishnah and Gemara using 'all' even for two. Nevertheless, Bereshit Rabbah's exposition of 'There was famine in all lands' says: in three lands—Phoenicia, Arabia, and Palestine. They appear to infer three lands from 'all,' following the earlier authorities. It appears that 'all' is indeed three: two extremes and the middle that includes them, the usual reckoning in holiness. Opposite this, the shells have three familiar evil qualities: jealousy, desire, and honor, the three roots of idolatry, forbidden relations, and bloodshed."

Zohar, Terumah 66:669: "'With all your heart' means with two hearts, the two inclinations: one good and one evil. Each is called heart: one a good heart, the other an evil heart. Therefore levavkha, 'your heart,' denotes two: the good and evil inclinations."

Context: The explicit Zohar passage interpreting levavkha as the two inclinations is Terumah 66:669; the text's folio pointer reads II 62b.

כְּגִידִין".[36] **Rather, it refers to what was said prior to Sinai: "and tell (ve-tagid) the children of Israel" (Exodus 19:3), which Rashi expounds: "penalties and exactitudes he explained to the men, matters as hard as sinews (giddin)."** וְכִי הַאי גַּוְונָא דְּרִשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת פז עמוד א) עַל פָּסוּק "וַיַּגֶּד מֹשֶׁה": "דְּבָרִים שֶׁקָּשִׁין לְאָדָם כְּגִידִין",[37] **And similarly the Gemara (Shabbat 87a) expounds on "And Moses reported (va-yaged)": "matters that are as hard for a person as sinews,"** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ" – דְּלָא יִמְטֵי עֲלַיְיכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ. **and concerning these warnings Scripture states: "And through all that I have warned you, you shall be preserved (tishameru) so that no evil shall reach you."**

וְהִנֵּה בְּכָל מָקוֹם לְשׁוֹן "כֹּל" הוּא עַל כָּל פָּנִים עַל שְׁנֵי דְּבָרִים – וְדַעַת כַּמָּה מֵהַקַּדְמוֹנִים דְּ"כֹּל" הוּא לְפָחוֹת עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה אַף מָצִינוּ לְשׁוֹן "כֹּל" עַל שְׁנֵי דְּבָרִים גַּם כֵּן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ "בְּכָל לְבָבְךָ" בַּגְּמָרָא (רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק הָרוֹאֶה) וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב, סב סוֹף עמוד ב) עַל יֵצֶר טוֹב וְיֵצֶר הָרָע (וְנִתְבָּאֵר וַיְחִי מַאֲמָר ג), אֲבָל עַל כָּל פָּנִים לֹא פָּחוֹת מִשְּׁנֵי דְּבָרִים.[38] **Now in all scriptural contexts the word "all" (kol) applies at the very least to two things—and several early authorities maintain that "kol" implies at least three; yet we find "kol" applied to two things as well, such as "with all (be-khol) your heart" expounded in Berakhot (54a) and the Zohar (II 62b) as referring to the good inclination and the evil inclination (explained in Vayechi, Discourse 3), but in any event never fewer than two.** אָכֵן בַּתּוֹרָה לֹא כָּתוּב שְׂכַר וְעֹנֶשׁ עוֹלָם הַבָּא – גֵּיהִנֹּם וְגַן עֵדֶן – רַק שְׂכַר וְעֹנֶשׁ דְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה; **Indeed, in the Written Torah the transcendent reward and punishment of the World to Come—Gehinnom and Gan Eden—are not explicitly recorded, only the physical rewards and punishments of this world;** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַשָּׂכָר וְעֹנֶשׁ לֹא נִכְתַּב כְּלָל, דְּלָמָּא אָתוּ לְמֶעְבַּד מִיְּרָאָה עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה כה עמוד ב),[39] **and we have already explained that reward**

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[36] **Megillah 25b**: "Warnings and punishments are read and translated publicly. Is this not obvious? One might have thought that we should be concerned lest people come to serve God out of fear. The teaching therefore tells us that they are nevertheless read and translated."

Context: The Talmud raises and rejects withholding the translation of punishments lest people serve from fear. Rav Tzadok invokes that concern, rather than its rejected practical ruling.

[37] **Shabbat 118b**: "Rav Nahman bar Yitzhak said: One who makes Shabbat a delight is rescued from subjugation by the exiles. Here it is written, "I will cause you to ride upon the heights of the earth," and elsewhere it is written, "You shall tread upon their high places.""

Shabbat 118a: "Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi said in Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi's name, in the name of Bar Kappara: Whoever fulfills the duty of three Shabbat meals is rescued from three calamities: the travail of the Messiah, the judgment of Gehinnom, and the war of Gog and Magog. For the Messiah's travail, "day" appears here and also in "Behold, I am sending you Elijah the prophet before the coming of the day." For Gehinnom's judgment, "day" appears here and also in "That day is a day of wrath." For the war of Gog and Magog, "day" appears here and also in "On the day Gog comes.""

[38] **Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 1**: "'These are the names.' Thus Scripture says, 'One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him seeks discipline for him early.' Ordinarily, if one person tells another, 'So-and-so struck your son,' the father pursues that man to the utmost. Why, then, does Scripture say, 'One who withholds his rod hates his son'? To teach that whoever withholds discipline from his son will ultimately see him take a corrupt path and come to hate him."

Deuteronomy 8:5: "Know in your heart that Hashem your God disciplines you as a father disciplines his child."

Proverbs 13:24: "One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him is diligent in disciplining him."

Shemot Rabbah 1:1: ""These are the names of the children of Israel who came to Egypt with Jacob; each man came with his household." This is what Scripture says: "One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him disciplines him early." Ordinarily, if someone tells a man, "So-and-so struck your son," he becomes his bitter enemy. What, then, does "One who withholds his rod hates his son" teach? Whoever withholds discipline from his son will ultimately see him fall into evil ways, and will hate him."

[39] **Eruvin 19a**: "Thus Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: What is meant by "Those passing through the valley of weeping make it a spring; the teacher is also clothed in blessings"? "Those passing" are people who transgress the will of the Holy One, blessed be He. "The valley"—Gehinnom is deepened for them. "Weeping"—they weep and shed tears like a spring flowing into the depths. "The teacher is also clothed in blessings"—they accept their judgment as just, saying: Master of the world, You have judged well, acquitted well, condemned well, and rightly prepared Gehinnom for the wicked and Eden for the righteous. Is that so? Reish Lakish said: The wicked do not repent even at Gehinnom's entrance, as it says, "They shall go out and see the corpses of the people who rebel against Me." It does not say "who rebelled," but "who rebel," meaning that they continue rebelling forever. There is no difficulty: One statement concerns Israel's sinners, the other the sinners of the nations. This is also reasonable, since otherwise Reish Lakish would contradict himself. Reish Lakish said: Gehinnom's fire does not rule over Israel's sinners. This follows all the more from the golden altar: Though covered by only a dinar's thickness of gold, it stood for many years without fire ruling over it. How much more so Israel's sinners, who are filled with mitzvot like a pomegranate! For "Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate" may be read, "Even your empty ones are filled with mitzvot like a

and punishment were not written at all, lest people come to act out of fear (Megillah 25b), רַק נִכְתְּבוּ הַסַּיְיעְתּוֹת: שֶׁבְּאִם תִּשְׁמְעוּ יִשְׁלַח הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כָּל הַסַּיְיעְתּוֹת שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה לָכֶם שׁוּם טִרְדָּא, וְיִהְיֶה מְלַאכְתָּם נַעֲשֵׂית עַל יְדֵי אֲחֵרִים, וְיִהְיֶה פָּנוּי רַק לְשַׁמֵּשׁ אֶת קוֹנוֹ לַתּוֹרָה וַעֲבוֹדָה; **rather, the Torah recorded divine assistances: that if you obey, Hashem will send material blessings so that you suffer no worldly distractions, your physical labor being performed by others, leaving you free solely to serve your Maker in Torah and divine worship;** וּבְהֵיפֶךְ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם גַּם כֵּן יִשְׁלַח הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַסַּיְיעְתּוֹת – הַיִּסּוּרִין – כְּדֵי לְעוֹרֵר אֶת הָאָדָם לִתְשׁוּבָה. **and conversely, Heaven forbid, Hashem sends the assistances of corrective tribulations to awaken a person to repentance.** אֲבָל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁהִגִּיד לָהֶם "דְּבָרִים הַקָּשִׁין כְּגִידִין", פֵּירֵשׁ לָהֶם עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַבָּא שֶׁהֵם הָעִיקָּר, וְגַם עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה; **However, Moses our teacher, who orally told them "matters as hard as sinews," explicitly revealed to them both the punishments of the World to Come (which are primary) and the punishments of this world;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם" – דְּאַגְזֵימִית לְכוֹן עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַבָּא וְעוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה – "תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ" עַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת שַׁבָּת, דְּלָא יִמְטֵי לְכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ; **and concerning this it is stated: "And in all (u-vekhol, encompassing both categories) that I have said unto you, you shall be preserved (tishameru)"—namely, through the observant rest of Shabbat, so that no evil shall reach you;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קיח עַמּוּד א) שֶׁהַמְקַיֵּים שָׁלֹשׁ סְעוּדוֹת בְּשַׁבָּת שֶׁהֵם בְּרָזָא דְּעֹנֶג וּמִלְּחֶמֶת גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג; וְהַמְעַנֵּג אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת נִיצוֹל מִשְּׁעְבּוּד בֶּן דָּוִד.[40] **as taught in Shabbat (118a): whoever observes the three Shabbat meals, which operate in the mystery of Oneg, is saved from three tribulations: the birth pangs of the Messiah, the judgment of Gehinnom, and the war of Gog and Magog; and one who delights in the Sabbath is saved from foreign servitude.**

"אַךְ לְפִי זֶה הָוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר: "וּמִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ", דְּלָא יִמְטֵי עֲלַיְיכוֹן, מַאי "וּבְכֹל"? **Yet according to this, Scripture should have said: "And from all (u-mikol) that I have warned you, be saved," so why does it say "And in all (u-vekhol)"?** וְעַל זֶה מְדַיֵּיק הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: שֶׁעַל יְדֵי "דְּאַגְזֵימִית לְכוֹן" – עַל יְדֵי זֶה "תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ דְּלָא יִמְטֵי עֲלַיְיכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ", עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהַפַּחַד יְעוֹרֵר אֶתְכֶם לָשׁוּב בִּתְשׁוּבָה שְׁלֵימָה. **And upon this the holy Zohar pinpoints: through the very fact that "I threatened you with these severe penalties," by that very fear you shall be preserved (tishameru) so that no evil strikes you, because that holy fear awakens you to return in complete repentance!**

וְהִנֵּה עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה בְּוַדַּאי בָּאִים דֶּרֶךְ רְפוּאָה, "כַּאֲשֶׁר יִיַּסֵּר אִישׁ אֶת בְּנוֹ", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמוֹת) עַל גָּלוּת מִצְרַיִם: "חוֹשֵׁךְ שִׁבְטוֹ וְגוֹמֵר וְאוֹהֲבוֹ שִׁחֲרוֹ מוּסָר".[41] **Now the tribulations of this world certainly arrive by**

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pomegranate." What then of "Those passing through the valley of weeping"? It concerns those liable to Gehinnom at that time; Abraham comes, raises them out, and receives them—except an Israelite who had relations with a gentile woman, whose foreskin extends so that Abraham does not recognize him. Rav Kahana challenged: Since you interpret "who rebel" as ongoing rebellion, would "who brought out" and "who brought up" also mean that He continually brings out and brings up? Rather, these refer to His having brought out and brought up; here too the verse can refer to their having rebelled."

Isaiah 66:24: "They will go out and see the corpses of the people who rebelled against Me. Their worm will not die, and their fire will not be extinguished, and they will be an abhorrence to all flesh."

[40] **Shemot Rabbah 7:4**: "Just as praise of the Holy One, blessed be He, rises to Him from the righteous in the Garden of Eden, so it rises from the wicked in Gehinnom, as it says, "Those passing through the valley of weeping make it a spring." What is "make it a spring"? They shed tears like springs until they cool Gehinnom with their tears, and from there praise rises, as it says, "The teacher too shall be clothed in blessings." What do they say? Rabbi Yochanan said: Rightly You spoke; rightly You judged; rightly You declared pure; rightly You declared impure; rightly You found liable; rightly You taught; rightly You instructed."

[41] **Eruvin 19a**: "Thus Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: What is meant by "Those passing through the valley of weeping make it a spring; the teacher is also clothed in blessings"? "Those passing" are people who transgress the will of the Holy One, blessed be He. "The valley"—Gehinnom is deepened for them. "Weeping"—they weep and shed tears like a spring flowing into the depths. "The teacher is also clothed in blessings"—they accept their judgment as just, saying: Master of the world, You have judged well, acquitted well, condemned well, and rightly prepared Gehinnom for the wicked and Eden for the righteous. Is that so? Reish Lakish said: The wicked do not repent even at Gehinnom's entrance, as it says, "They shall go out and see the corpses of the people who rebel against Me." It does not say "who rebelled," but "who rebel," meaning that they continue rebelling forever. There is no difficulty: One statement concerns Israel's sinners, the other the sinners of the nations. This is also reasonable, since otherwise Reish Lakish would contradict himself. Reish Lakish said: Gehinnom's fire does not rule over Israel's sinners. This follows all the more from the golden altar: Though covered by only a dinar's thickness of gold, it stood for many years without fire ruling over it. How much more so Israel's sinners, who are filled with mitzvot like a pomegranate! For "Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate" may be read, "Even your empty ones are filled with mitzvot like a

way of loving cure, "as a father chastens his son" (Deuteronomy 8:5), as expounded in the Midrash (Shemot Rabbah 1:1) on the Egyptian exile: "He that spares his rod hates his son, but he that loves him chastens him betimes" (Proverbs 13:24). אַף עוֹנְשֵׁי גֵּיהִנֹּם שֶׁאָז אֵינוֹ זְמַן תְּשׁוּבָה, הֵם גַּם כֵּן לְטוֹבָה שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה לֹא יִמְּטֵי לְכוֹן; **Furthermore, even the cleansing punishments of Gehinnom—where active repentance is no longer possible—are likewise for the ultimate good of Jewish souls so that permanent doom never reaches them;** דְּרַק בָּעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת שֶׁפּוֹשְׁעִין וְהוֹלְכִים, שֶׁאֲפִילּוּ עַל פִּתְחוֹ שֶׁל גֵּיהִנֹּם אֵינָם חוֹזְרִין, כְּתִיב: "וְאִשָּׁם לֹא תִכְבֶּה",[42] **for only regarding idolaters who persist in rebellion, refusing to repent even at the very entrance of Gehinnom (Eruvin 19a), is it written: "neither shall their fire be quenched" (Isaiah 66:24);** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּכְנָסִין לְגֵיהִנֹּם וּמוֹרִידִין דְּמָעוֹת כְּמַעְיָנוֹת עַד שֶׁמְּצַנְּנִין גֵּיהִנֹּם בְּדִמְעוֹתֵיהֶן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׁמּוֹת רַבָּה ז',[43] **whereas the sinners of Israel who enter Gehinnom weep tears like flowing springs until they cool Gehinnom with their tears (Shemot Rabbah 7:4),** וּמִיָּד מַצְדִּיקִין הַדִּין, וּמִיָּד אָתֵי אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין יט עַמּוּד א).[44] **and immediately acknowledge the divine justice, whereupon our father Abraham, peace be upon him, descends and draws them up from Gehinnom (Eruvin 19a).** וַאֲפִילּוּ זֶה דְּמָשְׁכָה עָרְלָתוֹ וְכוּלֵי, כְּבָר אָמְרוּ דְּרַק אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אֵינוֹ מַכִּירוֹ שֶׁנִּימּוֹל, **And even regarding one whose foreskin was artificially drawn down (meshukh orlah) to conceal his circumcision,** אֲבָל אֵלִיָּהוּ מַלְאַךְ הַבְּרִית, שֶׁהוּא עֵד רְאִיָּה עַל כָּל מִילוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א, צג עַמּוּד א), הוּא יַסְהִיד דִּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַיְּימִין הַאי קְיָימָא, עַיֵּין שָׁם, וְיָעִיד עַל זֶה גַּם כֵּן[45] **Elijah, the Angel of the Covenant—who is an**

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pomegranate." What then of "Those passing through the valley of weeping"? It concerns those liable to Gehinnom at that time; Abraham comes, raises them out, and receives them—except an Israelite who had relations with a gentile woman, whose foreskin extends so that Abraham does not recognize him. Rav Kahana challenged: Since you interpret "who rebel" as ongoing rebellion, would "who brought out" and "who brought up" also mean that He continually brings out and brings up? Rather, these refer to His having brought out and brought up; here too the verse can refer to their having rebelled."

[42] **Zohar, Lech Lecha 33:378-35:390**: "Come and see: first it says, 'What are you doing here, Elijah?' He answered, 'I have been exceedingly zealous for the Lord…for the children of Israel have forsaken Your covenant.' God told him: 'By your life, wherever My children inscribe this holy mark in their flesh, you shall be present. The mouth that testified that Israel forsook the covenant shall testify that Israel fulfill it.' We learned: why was Elijah punished before God? Because he spoke accusations against His children."

Context: The Zohar establishes Elijah's attendance and testimony at circumcision. The application to one whose foreskin was drawn forward is Rav Tzadok's development.

[43] Parallel: **Gloss in Nefesh HaChayim, Gate I 12:9–10**: "The measure of good is greater, by an immense difference and advantage: the radiance and added holiness produced by a person's good deeds endure eternally, and his soul delights in them with everlasting pleasure. But the forces of impurity and destructive beings created and multiplied by his sins die and perish of themselves after he has received the entire punishment allotted to him. Their very vitality comes only from the damage of sin and the destruction he caused in the holy powers and worlds. From this they receive a flow of vitality and a little light through crooked channels, as in 'I shall be filled from her devastation.' Once he has undergone judgment through them, 'He swallowed wealth and shall vomit it out': their vitality is automatically cut off, and they perish of themselves. This is why Gehinnom is called a leech. A leech draws out the bad blood and immediately dies from it; so it is with Gehinnom, as explained."

Connection: The gloss adds a precise asymmetry: holiness endures, while the harmful powers sustained by sin lose their vitality after judgment, like the leech in its healing analogy.

[44] **Beit Yosef, Orach Chayim 288**: "In the Jerusalem Talmud we read: Rabbi Chaggai said, 'Sabbaths and festivals were given only for eating and drinking.' Rabbi Berechyah said, 'They were given only to occupy oneself with Torah.' Tanchuma explains that they do not disagree. Rabbi Berechyah's statement about Torah study concerns laborers, who work throughout the week and come on Shabbat to study Torah. Rabbi Chaggai's statement about enjoyment concerns Torah scholars, who labor in Torah throughout the week and enjoy themselves on Shabbat. As for Rava's statement that everyone agrees Shabbat requires an element 'for you,' as explained in section 242: one may answer that he addresses Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua; alternatively, there he requires some enjoyment, whereas here the discussion concerns devoting the whole day to enjoyment."

Context: Beit Yosef quotes the Tanchuma distinction between workers and Torah scholars.

Pesikta Rabbati 23: "Rabbi Berekhya said in Rabbi Chiya bar Abba's name: Shabbat was given only for delight. Rabbi Chaggai said in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name: Shabbat was given only for Torah study. They do not disagree. Rabbi Berekhya's statement in Rabbi Chiya bar Abba's name, "for delight," concerns Torah scholars, who toil in Torah all week and come on Shabbat to enjoy themselves. Rabbi Chaggai's statement in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name, "for Torah study," concerns workers, who are occupied with their labor throughout the week and come on Shabbat to occupy themselves with Torah."

[45] **Peri Tzadik, Sefer Kedushat Shabbat 7**: "Those immersed in worldly affairs throughout the weekdays find their Shabbat delight in Torah study. Rabbi Chiyya bar Abba, however, occupied himself with halakhic teaching, as Sotah 40 explains that everyone left him, for the masses desire aggadah. He therefore spoke to the scholars with whom he

eyewitness at every circumcision in Israel (Zohar I 93a)—testifies that Israel observes this covenant, and will testify on his behalf as well; וְאַף דְּמַשְׁכָּא עָרְלָתוֹ, הַמָּשׁוּךְ דִּינוֹ כְּמָהוּל וְהוּא בִּכְלַל כָּל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר דְּאִקְרֵי צַדִּיק, וְאֵלִיָּהוּ מַעֲלֶה אוֹתוֹ. **for halakhically the mashukh retains the status of being circumcised, belonging to all who are circumcised and termed "tzaddik," and Elijah raises him up from Gehinnom.**

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם" – דְּאַגְזֵימִית לְכוֹן עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְעוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַבָּא, דְּבָרִים הַקָּשִׁין כְּגִידִין – הוּא רַק סִבָּה שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה "תִּשָּׁמְרוּ", דְּלָא יִמְטֵי לְכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ: **And this is "And in all that I said unto you"—that the severe penalties of both worlds were revealed as an instrument so that you be protected, so that no evil reach you:** לֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַפַּחַד תָּשׁוּבוּ בִּתְשׁוּבָה; וְלֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא לְמִי שֶׁלֹּא יוֹעִילוּ לוֹ בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, דְּמִתְחַיְּבֵי רַק שַׁעְתָּא חָדָא וְתֵיכָף יַכִּירוּ הָאֱמֶת וְיִצְדְּקוּ הַדִּין, וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם מַעֲלֶה אוֹתָם.[46] **neither in this world, where awe stirs you to repentance; nor in the World to Come for one who did not repent in time, for such souls are punished only briefly until they acknowledge the Truth and divine justice, whereupon Abraham raises them up.**

וְזֶה יוֹעִיל קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁבִּשְׁנַת הַשְּׁמִיטָה דַּעֲלַהּ קָאֵי; **And this protective purification is mediated through the sanctity of the Sabbath within the Sabbatical Year (Shemitah), which this passage addresses;** וּבִשְׁנַת הַשְּׁמִיטָה כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּנוּיִם כָּל הַשָּׁנָה לַתּוֹרָה, וְהַשַּׁבָּתוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם הֵם לְהִתְעַנֵּג, כִּדְמוֹכֵי לַהּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי (סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה כג) וּבְתַנְחוּמָא הוּבָא בְּבֵית יוֹסֵף אֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן רפח): מַאן דְּאָמַר דִּלְתַעֲנוּג נִיתַּן הַשַּׁבָּת הַיְינוּ לְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים,[47] **for during the Shemitah year all Israel are free the entire year for Torah study, and their Sabbaths are dedicated to pure spiritual delight—in line with the teaching that Shabbat was given for physical-spiritual delight specifically to Torah scholars (Pesikta Rabbati 23; Tanchuma cited in Beit Yosef, O.C. 288)—** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְהִתְעַנֵּג עַל ה' (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת סוֹף מַאֲמָר ז), וְעַל יְדֵי עֹנֶג שַׁבָּת יִהְיֶה נִיצּוֹל מִגֵּיהִנֹּם וְשִׁעְבּוּד, וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְכֹל" דַּיְיקָא כָּאמוּר.[48] **meaning that they merit to "delight upon Hashem" (Isaiah 58:14), through which sacred delight they are delivered from Gehinnom and exile; and this is why Scripture states specifically "And in all (u-vekhol)", as explained.**

וְכֵן הָעִנְיָן בְּמָרָה, שֶׁאַחַר הַהִתְגַּלּוּת שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם בְּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף – דְּאִיתָא (בַּמְּכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם): "רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם – מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל" – **And so it was at Marah: following the supreme revelation at the Red Sea, where "a maidservant saw what Ezekiel did not see"—** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב: "וַיֵּצְאוּ אֶל מִדְבַּר שׁוּר", וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם ס"עַמּוּד א);[49] "נִפְקוּ לְמַדְבְּרָא לְאִסְתַּכָּלָא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי וְלָא אַשְׁכְּחוּהוּ **and afterward it is written: "and they went out into the wilderness of Shur" (Exodus 15:22), concerning which the Zohar (II 60a) states:**

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studied in the academy; for them, the main purpose is delight. This does not mean eating, drinking, and bodily pleasure. Shabbat 118 says 'one who delights the Sabbath,' rather than 'one who enjoys himself on Shabbat.' … Only on Shabbat, which resembles the World to Come, does the Zohar say concerning the second meal, 'Then you shall delight above the Lord'—above the Lord, literally, for at that time the Holy Ancient One is revealed. Elsewhere it explains 'above the Lord' as the place concerning which 'from nothing' is said. This means above the name Havayah, which begins with wisdom, as explained."

Isaiah 58:14: "Then you will delight in Hashem. I will have you ride upon the heights of the earth and feed you the inheritance of your father Jacob, for Hashem's mouth has spoken."

[46] **Exodus 15:22**: "Moses led Israel onward from the Sea of Reeds. They went out into the wilderness of Shur and traveled three days in the wilderness without finding water."

Zohar, Beshalach 25:337-26:348: "'They traveled three days in the wilderness and found no water.' Water means Torah, as it says, 'Everyone who thirsts, come to the water.' Rabbi Yeisa asked: who had given them Torah here? The Torah had not yet been given to them. Rabbi Eleazar answered: they went out into the wilderness to gaze, but God removed the radiance of His glory from there. They went to gaze upon Him and did not find Him. We have learned that God is called Torah: water means Torah, and Torah means the Holy One, blessed be He."

[47] **Exodus 15:25**: "He cried out to Hashem, and Hashem showed him a tree. He threw it into the water, and the water became sweet. There He established a statute and an ordinance for them, and there He tested them."

[48] **Exodus 15:26**: "He said, "If you listen carefully to the voice of Hashem your God, do what is upright in His eyes, attend to His commandments, and observe all His statutes, I will place upon you none of the illnesses I placed upon Egypt, for I am Hashem, your healer.""

[49] **Yoma 86a**: "But for one guilty of profaning the Name, repentance alone cannot suspend punishment, nor can Yom Kippur atone, nor sufferings purge it. Rather, all of them together suspend punishment, and death purges it, as it says, "Hashem of Hosts has revealed in my hearing: This wrongdoing will not be atoned for you until you die.""

"they went out into the wilderness seeking to gaze upon the Holy One, blessed be He, and found Him not"; וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלֹא מָצְאוּ מָיִם", וְאֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה; **and this is what is meant by "and they found no water"—water being Torah;** וּמַקְשֶׁה הַמָּקוֹם הַזֹּהַר דַּעֲדַיִן לֹא הָיָה מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "דְּאוֹלִיפְנָא דְּקַדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא "תּוֹרָה' אִקְרֵי"', **and the Zohar asks: but the Giving of the Torah had not yet occurred! To which it answers: "We have learned that the Holy One, blessed be He, is Himself called Torah";** וַהֲיֵינוּ שֶׁהַמַּר לָהֶם מְאֹד מַה שֶּׁנִּסְתַּלֵּק מֵהֶם הַהַשָּׂגָה שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם, וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לִשְׁתּוֹת מַיִם מְמָרָה שֶׁלֹּא יָכְלוּ לְהַשִּׂיג כְּלָל. **meaning that they were deeply embittered over losing that immediate perception of the divine Presence, so that they could not drink the waters of Marah, being unable to perceive Godliness at all. "** וַיּוֹרֵהוּ ה' עֵץ" – וְאֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ "עֵץ חַיִּים לַמַּחֲזִיקִים בָּהּ" – "וַיִּמְתְּקוּ הַמָּיִם". "[50]**And Hashem showed him a tree"—a tree being the Tree of Life, the Torah—"and the waters were made sweet" (Exodus 15:25).** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הַמַּר לָהֶם, שֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁאַחַר הִתְגַּלּוּת כָּזֶה שֶׁהָיָה בְּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף הָיָה מְצִיאוּת שֶׁנִּסְתַּר הָאוֹר, מַה יוֹעִיל שֶׁנִּמְתְּקוּ הַמַּיִם, פֶּן יִסָּתֵר מֵהֶם הָאוֹר עוֹד לָהֶם בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף הָיָה מְצִיאוּת שֶׁנִּסְתַּר הָאוֹר, מַה יוֹעִיל שֶׁנִּמְתְּקוּ הַמַּיִם, פֶּן יִסָּתֵר מֵהֶם הָאוֹר עוֹד? **Yet their heart still ached: seeing that even after such a magnificent revelation as the Red Sea it was possible for the light to disappear, what would it avail that the waters were temporarily sweetened, lest the divine light become concealed from them again?** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט" – שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים, שֶׁהֵם עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְעוֹלָם הַבָּא, עַל יְדֵי זֶה יוּחְקְקוּ בְּלִבָּם הַדְּבָרֵי תוֹרָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד. **And concerning this reassurance Scripture states: "There He made for them a statute and an ordinance"—that through the ordinances (mishpatim), which are the rectifications and warnings of both worlds, the words of Torah would become permanently engraved upon their hearts forever.** וּבְמָכִילְתָּא נִדְרַשׁ: "חֹק – זֶה שַׁבָּת", **And in the Mekhilta it is expounded: "'A statute'—this is Shabbat,"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת וְעֹנֶג שַׁבָּת, עַל יְדֵי זֶה "תִּשָּׁמְרוּ דְּלָא יִמְטֵי לְכוֹן שׁוּם "בִּישׁ", וְיוּחְקְקוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, וְיוֹעִיל מַה "דְּאַגָּזִימִית לְכוֹן" הָעוֹנָשִׁים הַקָּשִׁים כְּגִידִין שֶׁמְּרוּמָּז בְּתֵיבַת "וּמִשְׁפָּט". **meaning that through the commandment and sacred delight of Shabbat, "you shall be preserved so that no evil reaches you," the words of Torah will be engraved in your hearts eternally, and the severe penalties threatened will have achieved their protective goal, as alluded to in the word "and an ordinance (u-mishpat)."**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ כָּתוּב: "אִם שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמַע וְגוֹמֵר כָּל הַמַּחֲלָה וְגוֹמֵר", וְאֵינוֹ מוּבָן: מֵאַחַר שֶׁיִּשְׁמַע לְקוֹל ה' וַיַּאֲזִין לְמִצְוֹתָיו וְיִשְׁמוֹר הַחֻקִּים, לָמָּה יֵיסַּר בְּמַחֲלַת מִצְרַיִם?[51] **And right after this it is written: "If you will diligently hearken... all the diseases of Egypt I will not put upon you" (Exodus 15:26)—which seems redundant: if one hearkens to Hashem's voice, observes His commandments, and guards His statutes, why would anyone even imagine that he would be stricken with the diseases of Egypt?!** אַךְ שָׁם מְדַבֵּר בְּמִי שֶׁקִּלְקֵל וְיַעֲשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה – עֲזִיבַת הַחֵטְא לְהַבָּא – **Rather, the verse addresses one who sinned in the past and now repents, forsaking sin for the future—and concerning** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "אִם שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמַע לְקוֹל ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ, וְהַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינָיו תַּעֲשֶׂה, וְהַאֲזַנְתָּ לְמִצְוֹתָיו וְגוֹמֵר", הַכֹּל לְהַבָּא. **this it states: "If you will diligently hearken to the voice of Hashem your God, and do that which is right in His eyes, and give ear to His commandments, etc.," all of which refer to future conduct.** אַךְ עַל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פו עַמּוּד א) הָעָבָר,[52] הָא יֵשׁ חִלּוּקֵי כַּפָּרָה, וּבִכְרֵת חִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם שֶׁכֻּלָּן תּוֹלִין וּמִיתָה מְמָרֶקֶת **Yet concerning sins of the past, there are four categories of atonement (Yoma 86a), especially the desecration of the Divine Name (chillul Hashem) where repentance and Yom Kippur only suspend judgment and physical**

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[50] **Arizal, teaching quoted by R. Tzadok, Peri Tzadik, Mishpatim 2**: “The holy Ari teaches that the portions of Shovavim are a time for repairing damage to the covenant: the sequence extends through ‘When you acquire a Hebrew slave.’ We have already explained that this damage brings enslavement. Canaan, who resulted from Ham’s violation of the covenant in the ark, was cursed to slavery. Thus ‘When you acquire a Hebrew slave’ concerns one whose damage brought him to be sold as a slave; nevertheless, ‘in the seventh he shall go free’—he can be repaired through the holiness of the lower Sabbath.”

Context: The link preserves Rav Tzadok’s explicit attribution; an independent original pinpoint is not supplied.

[51] **Shabbat 118b**: “Rabbi Hiyya bar Abba said in Rabbi Yohanan’s name: Whoever observes Shabbat according to its laws is forgiven, even if he has served idols like the generation of Enosh. For it says, “Happy is the mortal who does this ... who keeps Shabbat from profaning it.” Do not read mehallello, “from profaning it,” but mahul lo, “he is forgiven.””

[52] **Zohar, Bo 4:80-92**: “Rabbi Yose taught: in the very event in which judgment was found for the Egyptians, mercy was found for Israel, as in ‘I shall see the blood and pass over you.’ Likewise, in all the holy crowns above, where judgment is found, mercy is found, all at the same moment. Rabbi Chizkiyah taught: ‘The Lord shall strike Egypt, striking and healing’—striking Egypt and healing Israel. What is the healing? Having been circumcised, they needed healing.”

death cleanses; וְעַל זֶה בָּא סֵדֶר הַתְּשׁוּבָה וְהַצּוֹמוֹת מֵהָאֱלֹהֵי רַבִּי יִצְחָק הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר.[53] **and to rectify this the holy Ari and sacred works instituted specific fasts and penances to cleanse the past.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "וְשָׁמַרְתָּ כָּל חֻקָּיו" – "חֹק – זֶה שַׁבָּת" כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ בַּמְּכִילְתָּא, **And regarding this the verse concludes: "and keep all His statutes"—"a statute is Shabbat" as expounded in the Mekhilta,** וְעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת: "כָּל הַשּׁוֹמֵר שַׁבָּת מָחוֹל לוֹ אֲפִילּוּ עוֹבֵד עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה כְּאֱנוֹשׁ" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קיח עַמּוּד ב);[54] **for through observing Shabbat, "whoever observes Shabbat according to its law is forgiven even if he worshipped idols like the generation of Enosh" (Shabbat 118b);** וֶאֱנוֹשׁ הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁחִדֵּשׁ עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה, וְאֵין חִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה, וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם מוֹעִיל שַׁבָּת לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר. **and Enosh was the first in human history to innovate idolatry, than which there is no greater chillul Hashem, yet Sabbath observance possesses the power to rectify even that past!** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כָּל הַמַּחֲלָה אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְמִצְרַיִם" – דְּשָׂם עַל יְדֵי הַמַּכּוֹת הָיָה נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בֹּא לוֹ עַמּוּד א):[55] **And concerning this the verse says: "all the disease which I put upon Egypt"—where through the plagues there was a smiting of Egypt and a healing of Israel, as expounded in the Zohar (Bo 36a):** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַפַּחַד שֶׁהָיוּ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל מֵהַמַּכּוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "אֲשֶׁר יָגֹרְתָּ מִפְּנֵיהֶם", עַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיָצְאוּ מֵעִמְקֵי הַקְּלִיפּוֹת, עֲשֶׂר דַּרְגִּין דְּמָסָאבוּתָא.[56] **that through the holy terror Israel experienced witnessing the plagues ("which you were afraid of," Deuteronomy 28:60), they were purified and emerged from the ten depths of Egyptian defilement.** וְעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת שַׁבָּת: "לֹא אָשִׂים עָלֶיךָ כִּי אֲנִי ה' רֹפְאֶךָ" – **And through the mitzvah of Shabbat Hashem promises: "I will not put them upon you, for I am Hashem your Healer"— "** יְחוּד "ה'" – "אֲנִי" מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֲלָק ג, רכג רֵישׁ עַמּוּד א),[57] **I" (Ani) represents the attribute of Malchut, and the Name Havayah represents the supreme union of the Holy One and His Shechinah (Zohar III 223a), "** רֹפְאֶךָ" – שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ יְעוֹרֵר בְּעַצְמוֹ עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת שֶׁבּוֹ יִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ לְתַקֵּן כָּל הֶעָבָר, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה "רֹפְאֶךָ". **"your Healer"—meaning that Hashem Himself awakens through the sanctity of Shabbat, wherein this supreme unification occurs, to heal and rectify the entire past, becoming your ultimate Healer.**

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ (קו עַמּוּד ב) שֶׁהֵבִיא פָּסוּק: "דְּרָכָיו רָאִיתִי וְאֶרְפָּאֵהוּ" שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּפָרָשַׁת "הַצַּדִּיק אָבָד" שֶׁמְּיוּסָּד עַל פֶּגַם הַבְּרִית (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר וַיֵּשֶׁב מַאֲמָר ד),[58] **And this connects to what the holy Zohar states in our portion (II**

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[53] **Deuteronomy 28:60**: “He will bring back upon you all the illnesses of Egypt that you dreaded, and they will cling to you.”

[54] **Zohar, Pinchas 32:178-35:188**: “Another interpretation of ‘Guard my soul, for I am pious’: why? So that I may show kindness to Ani, ‘I,’ of which ‘Ani and Vahu’ are said. Woe to one who separates ‘I’ from ‘He,’ as in ‘He made us, and not we ourselves.’ All is one, without separation: ‘See now that I, I am He; I cause death and give life, I wound and I heal, and none rescues from My hand.’ ‘I am the Lord’: I am He and no other. This Ani comes from Adonai; the Name yod-he-vav-he is the middle pillar.”

Context: The Zohar insists on the unity of Ani and Hu; Rav Tzadok applies that unitive reading to the phrase Ani Hashem.

[55] **Isaiah 57:18**: “I have seen his ways, and I will heal him. I will guide him and restore comfort to him and to those who mourn for him.”

Peri Tzadik, Vayeshev 4: “These verses are written in the passage 'The righteous one has perished,' which concerns the blemish of the covenant throughout. Thus 'Those who slaughter the children' is expounded in Niddah 13 concerning this blemish. The passage concludes, 'For the spirit would faint before Me, and the souls I made,' which is expounded there to mean that the son of David will not come until all the souls in the body have been exhausted. This entire Torah portion likewise discusses rectification of the covenant’s blemish.”

Zohar, Mishpatim 3:230-239: “Come and see: ‘He went waywardly in the path of his heart.’ Immediately afterward, ‘I have seen his ways and shall heal him; I shall guide him and restore consolations to him and his mourners.’ ‘He went waywardly’: although the wicked deliberately do whatever they do, following their hearts, and although others warn them and they refuse to listen, when they return in repentance and take its good path, healing stands ready to meet them.”

[56] **Isaiah 57:17**: “Because of the sin of his greed I became angry and struck him; I hid Myself and was angry, yet he went on waywardly along the path of his heart.”

[57] **Exodus 32:34**: “Now go; lead the people to the place I told you. My angel will go before you, but on the day I call them to account, I will call them to account for their sin.”

[58] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Balak 11:1**: “The principal healing, the healing of the soul, certainly comes through words of Torah, as it says, ‘Healing for all his flesh’; this concerns the past. Deliverance from the evil inclination for the future also comes through Torah, as Zohar I, 202a, says: nothing breaks the evil inclination except Torah. Sometimes healing comes through Torah conveyed by a reprover who brings words of Torah into the heart, so that the person returns in repentance and is healed. Some sins, however, cannot be healed through Torah conveyed by an emissary,

106b), citing the verse: "I have seen his ways, and will heal him" (Isaiah 57:18), which appears in the chapter "The righteous man perishes" that treats the rectification of the Covenant (as explained in Vayeshev, Discourse 4), וְהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ פֶּגֶם הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהֵטִיל זוּהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה. **which is the primordial blemish of the Serpent who injected defilement into Eve.** וּכְתִיב: "וַיֵּלֶךְ שׁוֹבֵב בְּדֶרֶךְ לִבּוֹ" – דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע דְּבֵיהּ תַּקִּיף וְאִתְתַּקַּף בֵּיהּ וְלָא בָּעֵי לְאָתָבָא בִּתְיוּבְתָּא;[59] **And it is written: "and he went on frowardly in the way of his heart" (Isaiah 57:17)—meaning the evil inclination in him is so overwhelmingly fierce that on his own he lacks the strength to turn in repentance;** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא חָמֵי אוֹרְחֵיהּ דְּקָא אָזְלִין בְּבִישׁ בְּלָא תּוֹעַלְתָּא, אָמַר קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא: "אֲנָא צְרִיכְנָא לְאִתְתַּקָּפָא בִּידֵיהּ: 'דְּרָכָיו רָאִיתִי וְאֶרְפָּאֵהוּ'", קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא אַעֲיל בְּלִבֵּיהּ דִּתְיוּבְתָּא וְאַסְוָותָא לְנַשְׁמָתֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי. **the Holy One, blessed be He, sees his ways leading toward futile ruin, and says: "I must strengthen his hand: 'I have seen his ways, and will heal him'"—and the Holy One infuses into his heart the path of repentance and spiritual healing for his soul, etc.** מְפָרֵשׁ הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ "וְאֶרְפָּאֵהוּ" עַל רְפוּאַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ, **Thus the holy Zohar expounds "and I will heal him" as the inner healing of the soul,** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמֹה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "כִּי אֲנִי ה' רֹפְאֶךָ". **precisely in line with what we explained on "for I am Hashem your Healer": that Hashem Himself initiates the awakening of repentance through the supernal unification of Shabbat. "** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יִהְיֶה הַמְעוֹרֵר לְתְשׁוּבָה עַל יְדֵי יִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ שֶׁהוּא קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת: וְאַנְחֵהוּ" – מְפָרֵשׁ הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: "לַךְ נְחֵה אֶת הָעָם", שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַנְהִיגוֹ לְהַבָּא בְּדֶרֶךְ הַיָּשָׁר.[60, 61] **And "and I will lead him (ve-anchehu)"—the Zohar expounds: like "Go, lead (necheh) the people" (Exodus 32:34), meaning that Hashem guides him for the future along the straight path.**

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but only by God Himself. Although the principal repairing Torah is the Oral Torah—the abundant wisdom that repairs abundant anger—and comes through a teacher, when Torah illuminates the heart until the very name of God shines there, as in 'Though I sit in darkness, God is a light for me,' it is called healing by God Himself. That illness never returns. Bodily suffering likewise comes through sin, as Shabbat 55a says, 'There is no suffering without iniquity.' When the sin is repaired, the bodily suffering also receives lasting healing. This is 'Heal me, God, and I shall be healed.' Deliverance for the future can likewise come through Torah learned from a teacher, and is called deliverance through an emissary. It can sometimes be reversed: it is no greater than the giving of the Torah, of which it says, 'I said, you are divine'—they would not die, as Avodah Zarah 5a explains. They were free from the angel of death, which is the evil inclination. Hearing 'You shall have no other' uprooted it from their hearts, as Shir HaShirim Rabbah, chapter 1, says; nevertheless, it subsequently returned. Even Adam in Eden, knowing nothing of evil, was approached there by the serpent, the evil inclination, to tempt him. But deliverance through Torah by which God's name shines within the heart is everlasting deliverance. Thus 'Heal me, God, and I shall be healed; save me, and I shall be saved': the healing is through God's name, as is deliverance for the future, making it everlasting. On Shabbat, when one merits the higher Shabbat and the evil inclination is removed from there, as Tikkunei Zohar 48 says, we therefore ask in Shabbat afternoon prayer, corresponding to Jacob, 'Answer me with the truth of Your salvation.' 'A truthful lip endures forever': the deliverance should last forever, so that the evil inclination never returns. Someone who merits this is immediately and completely redeemed."

Connection: The parallel explains the distinctive force of God's own healing: Torah can illuminate the heart so deeply that healing and future deliverance cease to be temporary.

[59] **Arizal, Sha'ar Ruach HaKodesh 43:2 (the Shovavim penitential practice)**: "Concerning the well-known Shovavim: Israel has an ancient custom of fasting forty consecutive days, from the first day of the week of Shemot through Terumah and part of Tetzaveh. The mnemonic 'Return, wayward children' uses the initials of Shemot, Va'era, Bo, Beshalach, Yitro and Mishpatim. These forty days of fasting were instituted principally for the sin of seminal emission; this period is more suited to fasting for that sin than the rest of the year. The reason follows our explanation of Egypt's exile through mortar and bricks. Those enslaved in Egypt were the sparks of souls that Adam emitted during the 130 years in which he separated from his wife and generated demons and spirits through seminal drops. All were repaired through that Egyptian exile. These portions therefore possess a special capacity for accepting the repentance of one fasting over that sin. The period begins with Shemot because the enslavement begins there, and ends with Mishpatim, for the reason explained concerning the adjacency of 'When you acquire a Hebrew slave' to the giving of the Torah: those sparks completed their repair in that passage. See that explanation."

[60] **Exodus 21:2**: "When you acquire a Hebrew servant, he shall serve six years; in the seventh he shall go free without payment."

[61] **Peri Tzadik, Shemot 4**: "In an individual case, however, someone may become corrupted and need to be sold as a slave to rectify this blemish. Of him it says, 'When you acquire...' and 'In the seventh year he shall go free': he has rectification through the aspect of the sabbatical year, the lower Sabbath. Even someone so deeply submerged that he says, 'I love my wife...' nevertheless has rectification through the jubilee, the higher Sabbath, the great shofar: 'Those cast away in the land of Egypt shall come.' Even those submerged in Egypt's shell, the nakedness of the land, will have repentance awakened in their hearts through the great shofar, the aspect of the higher Sabbath, the jubilee."

וְזֶה שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַגָּלֻיּוֹת וַאֲרִיכוּת הַגָּלוּת: שֶׁלֹּא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח, **And this is the root purpose of all the exiles and the prolonged dispersion: that none be cast away,** וְכָל שֶׁבָּא מִזֶּרַע יַעֲקֹב יֵשׁ לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עֲצוֹת וּדְרָכִים וּמִשְׁפָּטִים וְלֹא יִפּוֹל צְרוֹר אֶרְצָה. **for every soul stemming from the seed of Jacob, Hashem possesses designs and ordinances so that not a single grain falls to the earth.** וְעַל זֶה בָּא לְאַחַר הַדִּבְּרוֹת פָּרָשַׁת "וְאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים", מוֹסֵף עַל עִנְיָן רִאשׁוֹן: **And on this account, immediately following the Ten Commandments, comes the portion "Now these are the ordinances," adding to the former topic: "** דִּינִין דְּנִשְׁמָתִין דְּאִתְדָּנוּ כָּל חַד וְכוּלֵי", שֶׁהֵם מִשְׁפְּטֵי וְעִצּוֹת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְתַקֵּן נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל אִם עַל יְדֵי גֵּיהִנֹּם אוֹ גִּלְגּוּלִים שֶׁסִּיֵּדֵר הַסָּבָא. "**the judgments of souls wherein each is judged, etc.," which are the divine ordinances to rectify the souls of Israel through Gehinnom or transmigrations as detailed by the Saba d'Mishpatim.** וְאִיתָא מֵהָאֱלֹהִי רַבִּי יִצְחָק הַקָּדוֹשׁ דְּפָרָשִׁיּוֹת שׁוֹבָבִים (שְׁמוֹת, וָאֵרָא, בֹּא, בְּשַׁלַּח, יִתְרוֹ, מִשְׁפָּטִים) זְמַן תִּיקּוּן לְפָגַם הַבְּרִית[62] **And it is taught from the holy Ari that the weeks of Shovavim are the primary season for rectifying the Covenant,** כִּי תִקְנֶה עֶבֶד עִבְרִי "וְהֵיינוּ עַד פָּרָשַׁת";[63] **which culminates in Parashat Mishpatim with "If you buy a Hebrew servant" (Exodus 21:2);** דִּכְתָב אָמַרְנוּ דְּפָגַם זֶה גּוֹרֵם עַבְדוּת, וּכְנַעַן שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי פְּגַם הַבְּרִית דְּחָם בַּהֲבָה נִתְקַלֵּל לְעֶבֶד (וְנִתְבָּאֵר שְׁמוֹת סוֹף מַאֲמָר ד),[64] **for as we explained, this blemish causes enslavement—Ham's sin in the Ark resulting in Canaan being cursed into servitude (explained in Shemot, end of Discourse 4)—** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כִּי תִקְנֶה עֶבֶד עִבְרִי" – שֶׁפָּגַם בָּזֶה עַד שֶׁנִּמְכַּר לְעֶבֶד; **and concerning this Scripture states: "If you buy a Hebrew servant"—who degraded himself to the point of being sold into servitude;** מִכָּל מָקוֹם "בַּשְּׁבִעִת יֵצֵא" – שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ תִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת תַּתָּאָה, **nevertheless "in the seventh he shall go out free"—for he achieves freedom through the sanctity of the Lower Shabbat;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ דְּשָׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת מוֹעִיל אַף לְחִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם דַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה דְּאֱנוֹשׁ, וּבְוַדַּאי מוֹעִיל לָזֶה גַּם כֵּן. **and as we noted, Shabbat observance forgives even the idol worship of Enosh, and certainly rectifies this blemish as well.**

וְאַף מִי שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּקַּע בַּחֲטָא עַד שֶׁאָמַר: "אָהַבְתִּי אֶת אֲדֹנִי אֶת אִשְׁתִּי וְאֶת בָּנַי",[65] **And even one who sank so deeply into defilement that he declared: "I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go out free" (Exodus 21:5)—** אַף שֶׁחֲשׁוּבָה כִּבְהֵמָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (קְדוּשִׁין סט עַמּוּד א): "וְלָךְ בִּמְעֵי שִׁפְחָה כְּנַעֲנִית כָּוֶלֶד בִּמְעֵי בְּהֵמָה דְּמֵי", וְאֵין הַבָּנִים בִּכְלַל זַרְעוֹ, וְהוּא אוֹמֵר "אָהַבְתִּי אֶת אִשְׁתִּי וְאֶת בָּנַי" – **even though a Canaanite maidservant is**

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[62] **Exodus 21:5**: “But if the servant insists, “I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go free,””

[63] **Zohar, Beshalach 4:52-5:63**: “Rabbi Abba said: happy is Israel’s portion, for God brought them out of Egypt to be His portion and inheritance. Come and see: Israel’s freedom was found from the side of Jubilee. So it will be in the future: ‘On that day a great shofar shall be sounded,’ and so forth.”

Isaiah 27:13: “On that day a great shofar will be sounded. Those lost in the land of Assyria and those cast away in the land of Egypt will come and bow down to Hashem on the holy mountain in Jerusalem.”

[64] **Jerusalem Talmud Demai 4:1:2**: “Someone who bought produce from a person not trusted regarding tithes, and forgot to tithe it, may ask him on Shabbat and eat on his assurance. After Shabbat has ended, he may not eat until he tithes. … The companions said in Rabbi Yohanan’s name: They permitted this in honor of Shabbat. If it is because of Shabbat’s honor, why must he ask? To create a basis for the permission. Rabbi Bibi said in Rabbi Hanina’s name: The awe of Shabbat rests upon him, so he tells the truth. If the awe of Shabbat rests upon him, why does the Mishnah say that once Shabbat ends he may not eat until he tithes? Because there may be someone upon whom the awe of Shabbat does not rest. A baraita teaches: If he asks on a weekday, he may not eat on Shabbat. This fits the view that the awe of Shabbat rests upon him. According to the view that permission is given for Shabbat’s honor, however, even if he asked on a weekday, he should be able to eat on Shabbat.”

Context: The statement is in the Jerusalem Talmud’s discussion of Demai 4:1, not Mishnah Demai 4:7.

[65] **Avodah Zarah 19a**: ““Happy is the man who fears Hashem.” Is a man happy, but a woman not? Rav Amram said in Rav’s name: Happy is one who repents while still a man in his strength. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: Happy is one who masters his inclination like a man.”

Berakhot 17a: “Rava often said: Wisdom’s purpose is repentance and good deeds. A person must not read Scripture and study Mishnah while rebelling against his father, his mother, his teacher, or someone greater than he in wisdom and seniority, as it says, “The beginning of wisdom is fear of Hashem; good understanding belongs to all who practice them.” It does not merely say “those who practice,” but “those who practice them”: those who act for its own sake, rather than those who do not. Whoever acts otherwise would have been better off not having been created.”

Commentary: **Rashi on Berakhot 17a:11:2**: ““One who acts not for its own sake would have been better off not having been created”: this means that he does not learn in order to fulfill the teaching, but in order to provoke. For in the chapter Makom Shenahagu, Rava contrasts “Your kindness reaches to the heavens” with “Your kindness is above the heavens,” distinguishing learning not for its own sake from learning for its own sake. That passage concerns someone who fulfills the teaching in order to receive honor. This also appears from the Jerusalem Talmud on our chapter.”

categorized as property, and the offspring of a maidservant is legally like the offspring of an animal, having no lineage to him, yet he perversely clings to them declaring "I love my wife and children"— מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ לוֹ תַּקָּנָה בַּיּוֹבֵל, וְהוּא קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת עִלָּאָה שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל **nonetheless he has an ultimate rectification in the Jubilee (Yovel), which is the sanctity of Supernal Shabbat (Binah), the Great Shofar,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּשַׁלַּח מו עַמּוּד ב): בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as written in the holy Zohar (Beshalach 46b):** דְּהַשׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל יִעוֹרֵר שֶׁיָּבֹאוּ אַף "הָאֹבְדִים בְּאֶרֶץ אַשּׁוּר" – שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּקְּעוּ שָׁם וְלֹא יָדְעוּ שֶׁרָשָׁם כְּלָל – "וְהַנִּדָּחִים בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם",[66] **that the Great Shofar will sound so that even "those who are lost in the land of Assyria"—who were so submerged that they forgot their holy origin entirely—and "those who are dispersed in the land of Egypt" (Isaiah 27:13),** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוֹדְעִים שָׁרְשָׁם, כְּמוֹ בְּמִצְרַיִם שֶׁהָיוּ מְצוּיָנִים שָׁם, וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיוּ מוּקָפִים בַּקְּלִיפָּה כְּעוּבָּר בְּמֵעֵי אִמּוֹ; **meaning those who remember their identity, like Israel in Egypt who were distinct yet enveloped within impurity like a fetus in the womb;** וְעַל יְדֵי הַשּׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל, יוֹבֵל עִלָּאָה, יְעוֹרֵר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלִבָּם הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה בֶּאֱמֶת.[67] **through that Great Shofar of the Supernal Jubilee, Hashem will stir genuine thoughts of repentance within their hearts.** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי אֵין הַפֵּירוּשׁ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת אֲפִילּוּ עוֹבֵד עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה כְּאֶנוֹשׁ מוֹחֲלִין לוֹ בִּכְדִי; **For certainly the teaching does not mean that merely external Sabbath observance wipes away the sin of idolatry without inner change;** רַק הַפֵּירוּשׁ דְּעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת זוֹכֶה לְיִרְאָה וָפַחַד, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי פֶּרֶק ד דְּמַאי הֲלָכָה ז): "אֵימַת שַׁבָּת עַל עַם הָאָרֶץ",[68] **rather, through observing Shabbat one merits divine awe, as taught in the Jerusalem Talmud (Demai 4:7): "The dread of Shabbat rests even upon the unlearned,"** וְעַל יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה בָּא לִתְשׁוּבָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאַר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מֵהַגְּמָרָא (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה יט עַמּוּד א וּבְרָכוֹת יז עַמּוּד א) דְּיִרְאָה וּתְשׁוּבָה הַכֹּל אֶחָד, שֶׁזֶּה תָּלוּי בָּזֶה;[69] [70] **and through that awe he arrives at true repentance, fear and repentance being one and interdependent;** וְזֶהוּ שַׁבָּת תַּתָּאָה: "אִיהִי יִרְאָה וְשַׁרְיָא בָּהּ יִרְאָה" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א, ה עַמּוּד ב),[71] **and this is Lower Shabbat: "it is Awe and Awe rests upon it" (Zohar I 5b),** וְזֶהוּ שׁוֹפָר שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל פַּחַד וְיִרְאָה, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אִם יִתָּקַע שׁוֹפָר בְּעִיר וְעָם לֹא יֶחֱרָדוּ" (עָמוֹס ג, ו).[72] **and the shofar arouses holy trembling, as stated: "Shall a shofar be blown in a city and the people not tremble?" (Amos 3:6).**

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[66] **Zohar, Introduction 12:74-84**: "Another Shabbat remained unmentioned and was ashamed. She said before Him: 'Master of the world, since You made me, I have been called Shabbat; yet there is no day without night.' He answered: 'My daughter, you are Shabbat, and Shabbat I call you; but I now crown you with a still higher crown.' He issued a proclamation: 'Revere My sanctuary.' This is Shabbat eve, which is fear, and fear rests within her. God included it by saying, 'I am the Lord.' I heard my father explain it thus: et adds the Shabbat boundary; 'My Shabbatot' is the circle and the square within it, two. Corresponding to them are two sanctifications we must mention: Vayekhullu and Kiddush. Vayekhullu contains thirty-five words, and the sanctification we recite contains thirty-five. Together they amount to the seventy Names with which God and the Congregation of Israel are crowned."

[67] **Amos 3:6**: "When a shofar is sounded in a city, do the people not tremble? Can calamity occur in a city unless Hashem has brought it about?"

[68] **Exodus 23:13**: "Be watchful concerning everything I have told you. Do not mention the name of other gods; let it not be heard from your mouth."

[69] **Avodah Zarah 4b**: "Concerning Torah, where "truth" is written—as in "Acquire truth and do not sell it"—the Holy One, blessed be He, does not go beyond the strict line of judgment. Concerning judgment, where "truth" is not written, the Holy One, blessed be He, does go beyond the strict line of judgment."

[70] **Ketubot 30b**: "Rav Yosef said, and Rabbi Chiya likewise taught: Since the Temple was destroyed, although the Sanhedrin ceased, the four forms of execution have not ceased. Have they not ceased? Surely they have. Rather, their punitive equivalents have not ceased. One liable to stoning either falls from a roof or is trampled by a wild beast. One liable to burning either falls into a fire or is bitten by a snake. One liable to the sword is either delivered to the authorities or attacked by bandits. One liable to strangulation either drowns in a river or dies from an obstructing throat illness."

[71] **Sotah 9a**: "Rav Ḥinnana bar Pappa said: The Holy One, blessed be He, does not exact punishment from a nation until its time of dismissal, as it says, "In measure, when You send her away." Is that so? Rava said: Why are three cups mentioned concerning Egypt? One is what it drank in Moses' days, one in Pharaoh Necho's days, and one it will drink with its companions in the future. Could those earlier Egyptians have disappeared and these be different people? Rabbi Yehuda taught: Minyamin, an Egyptian convert, was my fellow student of Rabbi Akiva. Minyamin said: I am a first-generation Egyptian convert and married a first-generation Egyptian woman. I will marry my son to a second-generation Egyptian woman, so that my grandson may enter the congregation. Rather, if the teaching was stated, it was stated thus: Rav Ḥinnana bar Pappa said: The Holy One, blessed be He, does not exact punishment from a king until his time of dismissal, as it says, "In measure, when You send her away, You contend with her.""

[72] **Proverbs 3:12**: "For Hashem reproves the one He loves, like a father the son whom he favors."
Proverbs 13:24: "One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him is diligent in disciplining him."

וְ"שׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל" – הַיְינוּ שַׁבָּת עִלָּאָה שֶׁהוּא בִּינָה, שֶׁהוּא יִרְאָה עִלָּאָה; **And the "Great Shofar" is Supernal Shabbat, Binah, Supernal Awe;** עַל יְדֵי הַשּׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל יַכְנִיס הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה אַף לָאוֹבְדִים וְהַנִּדָּחִים בְּקִלִּיפַּת מִצְרַיִם שֶׁהוּא פְּגַם הַתַּאֲוָה, **through this Great Shofar, Hashem will infuse thoughts of repentance even into those lost within the husks of Egypt, which is the blemish of lust,** דִּכְתִיב – "דְּרָכָיו רָאִיתִי וְאֶרְפָּאֵהוּ וְאַנְחֵהוּ" וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "רָאִיתִי הוּא אֲנַהֵג לֵיהּ וְאֶרְפָּאֵהוּ, שֶׁיַּכְנִיס בְּלִבּוֹ הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה בְּרִיךְ הוּא, **as it is stated: "I have seen his ways, and will heal him, and will lead him"—that the Holy One guides him and heals him, implanting repentance in his heart,** וְיִוָּשְׁעוּ וְיִתְּוַקֵּן הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מִכָּאן וּלְהַבָּא שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יַנְהִיגֵם בְּאֹרַח מִישׁוֹר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **so that they are saved and their future conduct is guided along the straight path, as the Zohar states.**

וְעַל הֶעָבָר בָּאוּ עוֹנְשֵׁי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְעוֹלָם הַבָּא, **And regarding the past, the purifications of this world and the World to Come were decreed,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַפַּחַד מֵהֶם יוֹעִיל קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת כְּשֶׁיָּבוֹאוּ בְּפֹעַל, שֶׁלֹּא יָבֹאוּ, **so that through the awe they instill, the sanctity of Shabbat will avail to prevent them having to materialize in actual fact,** וְיִהְיֶה דַּי בְּפַחַד הַגְּזוּיִים וְהַנְּהִימוּ סַגִּי; **it being sufficient merely that one experienced the dread of the threat and the loud roaring of the strap;** וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: "כְּלוֹמַר דְּאַגְזִימִית לְכוֹן עַל מֵימַר פּוּלְחָנִי תִּשְׁמְרוּ דְּלָא יְמְטֵי עֲלַיְיכוֹן שׁוּם בִּישׁ", **and as it is written: "And in all that I have warned you, you shall be preserved so that no evil strikes you,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַשַּׁבָּת יוֹעִיל שֶׁיּוֹעִיל הַפַּחַד, וְעַל יְדֵי הַגְּזוּם תִּהְיוּ נִשְׁמָרִים שֶׁלֹּא יָבֹאוּ בְּפֹעַל הָעוֹנָשִׁים.[73] **meaning that Shabbat enables the salutary fear to suffice, so that by virtue of the warning you are protected from the punishments ever having to occur in reality.**

וְ"שֵׁם אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים לֹא תַזְכִּירוּ" – "כְּלוֹמַר דְּלָא תְּסַבְּבוּן דְּתִפְּלוֹן בֵּינֵי עַמְמַיָּא וְכוּ'לֵי" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ",[74] **And make no mention of the name of other gods" (Exodus 23:13)—"that is to say: do not cause yourselves through sin to fall into exile among the nations, etc.," as written in the holy Zohar,** וְהַיְינוּ גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת כְּהִלְכָתָהּ, שֶׁזּוֹכִין שֶׁמִּיָּד נִגְאָלִין: **which is likewise attained through observing Shabbat according to its laws, whereby Israel merits immediate, complete redemption:**

מִשְׁפָּטִים, ג׳ Mishpatim — Maamar Gimmel

פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם מִשְׁפָּטִים, וְתֵיבַת מִשְׁפָּט בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ מַשְׁמָעָהּ עַל רַחֲמִים, **This portion is called Mishpatim, and in the holy Zohar the word mishpat, judgment, denotes mercy,** כְּדְאִיתָא בְּמַאֲמַר פָּתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ: מִשְׁפָּט יְדִיעָא דְּאִיהוּ רַחֲמֵי. **as stated in the passage Patach Eliyahu: "Mishpat is known as mercy."** וּבְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וּבְמִדְרָשׁ יוֹרֶה תֵּיבַת מִשְׁפָּט עַל הַדִּין. **In the Written Torah and the Midrash, however, the word mishpat denotes strict judgment.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה, דְּאִיתָא בִּגְמָרָא (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ד עַמּוּד ב): **We may explain this through the Gemara, Avodah Zarah 4b:** תּוֹרָה דִּכְתִיב בָּהּ אֱמֶת, אֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹשֶׂה לִפְנִים מִשּׁוּרַת הַדִּין; **"Regarding Torah, of which 'truth' is written, the Holy One blessed be He does not act beyond the strict measure of justice;** דִּין דְּלֹא כְתִיב בֵּיהּ אֱמֶת, הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹשֶׂה לִפְנִים מִשּׁוּרַת הַדִּין."[75] **regarding judgment, of which 'truth' is not written, the Holy One blessed be He acts beyond the strict measure of justice."** אַף דְּכָל הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם

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[73] **Job 42:5**: "I had heard of You through the hearing of the ear, but now my eye has seen You."

[74] **Shabbat 89b**: "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nahmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: What is meant by "For You are our Father; Abraham does not know us and Israel does not recognize us; You, Lord, are our Father, our Redeemer from of old is Your Name"? In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will say to Abraham: Your children have sinned against Me. He will answer: Master of the world, let them be wiped out for the sanctity of Your Name. God will say: I will tell Jacob, who suffered the hardship of raising children; perhaps he will ask mercy for them. He will say: Your children have sinned. Jacob will answer: Master of the world, let them be wiped out for the sanctity of Your Name. God will say: There is no reasoning among the elders and no counsel among the younger. He will say to Isaac: Your children have sinned against Me. Isaac will answer: Master of the world, are they my children and not Your children? When they put "We will do" before "We will hear," You called them "My firstborn son"; now are they my children and not Yours? Moreover, how much have they sinned? A person's years are seventy. Remove twenty for which You do not punish, leaving fifty. Remove twenty-five for the nights, leaving twenty-five. Remove twelve and a half for prayer, eating, and bodily needs, leaving twelve and a half. If You bear all of them, well and good; if not, half upon me and half upon You. And if You say that all must be upon me, I offered myself before You. They will begin saying, "For you are our father." Isaac will say: Instead of praising me, praise the Holy One, blessed be He. Isaac will point them toward the Holy One, blessed be He, with his eyes. They will immediately lift their eyes heavenward and say, "You, Lord, are our Father; our Redeemer from of old is Your Name.""

[75] **Psalms 45:11**: "Listen, daughter, consider and incline your ear; forget your people and your father's house."

יִתְבָּרַךְ הַמָּה עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה, **Although all the judgments of Hashem, blessed be He, accord with the Torah,** כְּדְאִיתָא (כְּתוּבוֹת ל רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב): דִּין אַרְבַּע מִיתוֹת לֹא בָּטְלוּ.[76] **as stated in Ketubot 30b, at the beginning of the page, "The judgment of the four forms of execution has not ceased,"** אָמְנָם יֵשׁ בְּחִינַת עֶבֶד וּבְחִינַת בֵּן. **nevertheless, there is the condition of a servant and the condition of a son.** בְּהָעֶבֶד כָּל הַדִּינִים וְהַיִּסּוּרִים הֵם בְּמִשְׁפָּט חָרוּץ, לְיַסְּרוֹ וּלְעַנְּשׁוֹ. **For the servant, all judgments and suffering are a decree of strict justice, to chastise and punish him.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ (סוֹטָה ט עַמּוּד א) דְּאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא נִפְרָע מֵהָאָמָּה עַד שְׁעַת שְׁלוּחָהּ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּסַאסְאָהּ וְגוֹמֵר.[77] **Therefore they said in Sotah 9a that the Holy One blessed be He does not exact retribution from a nation until the time of its expulsion, as it says, "Measure by measure," and so forth.** וְהַיְנוּ עַד שֶׁיִּתְמַלֵּא סְאָתָהּ, וְאָז מַאֲבִידָהּ לְגַמְרֵי. **That is, until its measure is full; then He destroys it entirely.** אֲבָל בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הַקְּרוּיִם בָּנִים לַמָּקוֹם, כָּל הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים וְהַדִּינִים וְהַיִּסּוּרִין הַמָּה רַק לִרְפוּאַת נַפְשׁוֹ, **For Israel, however, who are called children of the Omnipresent, all judgments, decrees, and suffering serve solely to heal the soul,** כְּרוֹפֵא הַחוֹתֵךְ בַּבָּשָׂר וְעוֹשֶׂה יִסּוּרִין כְּדֵי לְהַחֲיוֹתוֹ עַל יְדֵי זֶה, וְהוּא עוֹשֶׂה לְטוֹבָתוֹ שֶׁלֹּא יָמוּת. **like a physician who cuts into flesh and inflicts pain in order to preserve the patient's life, acting for his good so that he will not die.** כֵּן הָאָב הָרוֹדֶה אֶת בְּנוֹ לְהַדְרִיכוֹ בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַטּוֹב מֵאַהֲבָתוֹ אוֹתוֹ: **Likewise, a father disciplines his son to guide him along the good path because he loves him:** וְחוֹשֵׂךְ שִׁבְטוֹ שׂוֹנֵא בְנוֹ, וְכֵן אֶת אֲשֶׁר יֶאֱהַב הַשֵּׁם יוֹכִיחַ וּכְאָב אֶת בֵּן יִרְצֶה.[78] **"One who spares his rod hates his son," and likewise, "For Hashem reproves the one He loves, as a father the son whom he favors."** לָכֵן מָצִינוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לִהְיוֹת עֵדָה שׁוֹפֶטֶת וְעֵדָה מַצֶּלֶת וּמַכְרִיעַ בֵּינֵיהֶם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּשְׁנָה (רֵישׁ סַנְהֶדְרִין). **Therefore we find that a Sanhedrin requires a congregation that judges, a congregation that acquits, and a deciding voice between them, as stated at the beginning of Mishnah Sanhedrin.** וְגַם בְּדִינֵי מָמוֹנוֹת צָרִיךְ שְׁלֹשָׁה כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אֶחָד מַכְרִיעַ, וְהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת רַחֲמִים. **Monetary cases too require three judges so that one may decide between the others; this expresses mercy.** כִּי כָּל הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים וְהַדִּינִים הַשְּׁרוּיִין עַל נֶפֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל, הֲגַם שֶׁנִּתְחַיֵּב לְפִי מַעֲשָׂיו, עִם כָּל זֶה הַמָּה לְטוֹבָתוֹ, **For all judgments and decrees resting upon a soul of Israel, even when incurred through his deeds, nevertheless serve his good,** כִּי זוֹכֶה אַחַר כָּךְ לְהִתְקָרֵב לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת. **for afterward he merits drawing closer to Hashem, blessed be He, with still greater intensity.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּאִיּוֹב לְאַחַר הַיִּסּוּרִין שֶׁלּוֹ: לְשֵׁמַע אֹזֶן שָׁמַעְתִּיךָ וְעַתָּה עֵינִי רָאָתְךָ.[79] **This accords with what Job said after his suffering: "I had heard of You by the hearing of the ear, but now my eye has seen You."** דְּהַיְנוּ דְּקֹדֶם קַבָּלַת הַיִּסּוּרִין הָיָה לוֹ הַשָּׂגַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רַק בִּשְׁמִיעָה מֵרָחוֹק, וְעַתָּה אַחַר קַבָּלַת הַיִּסּוּרִין זָכָה לִרְאוֹת בְּחוּשׁ. **Before receiving**

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[76] **Exodus 21:2**: "When you acquire a Hebrew servant, he shall serve six years; in the seventh he shall go free without payment."

Context: The Shovavim teaching is in Tikkun 27, numbered 43:2 in Sefaria, and identifies the season from Shemot through Mishpatim.

Sha'ar Ruach HaKodesh 43:2 (Tikkun 27): "Concerning the well-known Shovavim: Israel has an ancient custom of fasting forty consecutive days, from the first day of the week of Shemot through Terumah and part of Tetzaveh. The mnemonic 'Return, wayward children' uses the initials of Shemot, Va'era, Bo, Beshalach, Yitro and Mishpatim. These forty days of fasting were instituted principally for the sin of seminal emission; this period is more suited to fasting for that sin than the rest of the year. The reason follows our explanation of Egypt's exile through mortar and bricks. Those enslaved in Egypt were the sparks of souls that Adam emitted during the 130 years in which he separated from his wife and generated demons and spirits through seminal drops. All were repaired through that Egyptian exile. These portions therefore possess a special capacity for accepting the repentance of one fasting over that sin. The period begins with Shemot because the enslavement begins there, and ends with Mishpatim, for the reason explained concerning the adjacency of 'When you acquire a Hebrew slave' to the giving of the Torah: those sparks completed their repair in that passage. See that explanation."

[77] **Exodus 21:5**: "But if the servant insists, "I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go free,""

[78] **Exodus 21:6**: "His master shall bring him before the judges and bring him to the door or doorpost. His master shall pierce his ear with an awl, and he shall serve him permanently."

[79] **Kiddushin 22b**: "Rabban Yohanan ben Zakkai interpreted this passage like an ornamental jewel: Why was the ear singled out from all the body's limbs? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: The ear heard My voice at Mount Sinai when I said, "For the children of Israel are My servants"—My servants, not servants of servants. Yet this man went and acquired a master for himself; let his ear be pierced. Rabbi Shimon son of Rabbi interpreted the passage like an ornamental jewel: Why were the door and doorpost singled out from all the household's furnishings? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: The door and doorpost were witnesses in Egypt when I passed over the lintel and the two doorposts and said, "For the children of Israel are My servants"—My servants, not servants of servants. I brought them from slavery to freedom, yet this man went and acquired a master for himself; let his ear be pierced before them."

Leviticus 25:55: "For the Israelites are servants to Me; they are My servants, whom I brought out of the land of Egypt. I am Hashem your God."